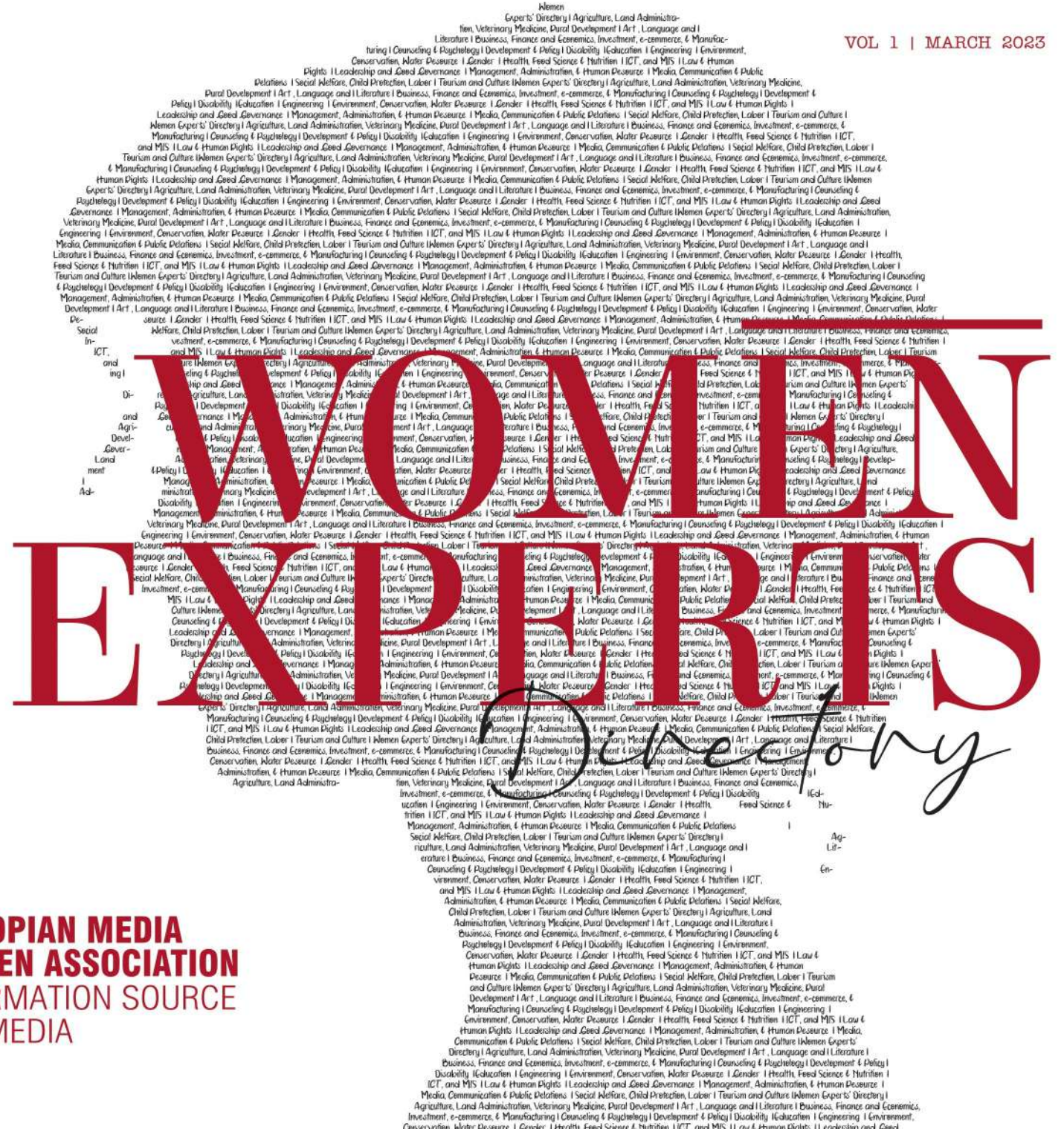
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ETHIOPIAN MEDIA WOMEN ASSOCIATION

INFORMATION SOURCE FOR MEDIA

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ETHIOPIAN MEDIA WOMEN ASSOCIATION

INFORMATION SOURCE FOR MEDIA

WOMEN EXPERTS

Directory

EMWA

Fojo Linnaeus University

IMS GOOD JOURNALISM | BETTER SOCIETIES

Sida SWEDISH INTERNATIONAL DEVELOPMENT COOPERATION AGENCY

MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS OF DENMARK *Danida*

Published by
ETHIOPIAN MEDIA WOMEN ASSOCIATION
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Disclaimer
Every effort has been made to verify the accuracy of the information contained in this Directory. However, the Ethiopian Media Women Association cannot accept responsibility for the consequences of its use for other purposes or in other contexts. The professional capacities and educational credentials illustrated in this Directory are not necessarily endorsed by the donors mentioned above.

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women Experts

women Experts

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women Experts

INTRODUCTION

Ethiopian women remain far less likely than their men counterparts to be used as media information sources. A Gender baseline assessment report published by Fojo-IMS in March 2021 indicated that the status of women as news sources in Ethiopia did not improve comparing research data from the last decade. Fojo-IMS gender baseline report recommended that women's representation in the media can be enhanced by diversifying the news sources of journalists and creating a database of women professionals operating in various fields.

Embracing the lessons learned from previous experiences and the actual need to create a gender-balanced media environment in Ethiopia, the Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA) aims to make women experts most visible to and accessible by the media through a printout directory and a database on EMWA's website. This Directory and the web database that can be accessed at https://emwaet.org,/ offer journalists and media organizations an effective tool for keeping up-to-date contact information about women professionals by sector. This Directory would also be one of the solutions to facilitate access to women professionals as new sources in regional and community radio content production. It will also encourage women professionals to come to the fore and it promotes visibility. Women experts profiled in this Directory are from diverse sectors and efforts have been made to give chance to represent women from major regional cities and zonal administrations, including Addis Ababa and Dire Dawa. To this end EMWA invited experts through different women networks, associations and organizations to share their profiles and contact information. They were also encouraged to send their profile through email and Telegram. An online google form was prepared so that the women experts easily fill their address and profiles along with their photographs.

More than 1,200 experts sent their data to the office, these were subsequently, encoded and of these, 200 experts were selected to be featured in the Directory based on their professional competence. It should however be noted that this is by no means an exhaustive list and EMWA regrets that it might miss very notable professional women who should have been in this list but did not get the chance to be in. The women experts' profile has been categorized under 18 various fields of disciplines in alphabetical order. Since it was difficult to include all women experts in this directory, the digital data base will give a chance for those who are interested to add their profile at https://emwaet.org/.

Finally, EMWA would like to thank Fojo-IMS for its support in finance and professional advice. EMWA is indebted to all women experts who willingly provided their profiles to make the Directory rich. Huge thanks goes to the designer for her impressive work and the data collectors who were vibrant enough to reach many of the women experts to be on the Directory.

EMWA Executive Board

MESSAGE FROM FOJO-IMS

This Women Professionals' Directory is a valuable tool to help increase the number of women experts as news sources and to promote gender representation. I sincerely hope journalists and other media professionals will use this directory to add more women expert sources wanting to incorporate Women voices in their stories.

Gender and media projects like this is an endeavour to pursue and complete, and it relies heavily on the collective efforts of people in the media sector and beyond. I would especially like to thank the Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA) for compiling and curating the biodata of women professionals in diverse fields. My gratitude goes to the women who shared their data believing in our cause to increase Women voices in the media. Special thanks to Selome Desta Belay, the former EMWA Board member who generously gave her time and expertise to this women professionals' database and published directory. Selome, I believe you kindled the sense of voluntarism in and around Ethiopian journalism professional associations. Thanks also go to EMWA's Women Directory Project Officer, Daniel Berhanu Teshome, who has relentlessly worked to put together the website database and the directory. I believe this is not the end – rather the beginning! Hopefully, EMWA will be able to update and curate the database with new women professionals' biodata to assist journalists in finding women experts on a subject of their choice.

Sofie Gullberg
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WOMEN EXPERTS

AGRICULTURE, LAND ADMINISTRATION, VETERINARY MEDICINE, RURAL DEVELOPMENT



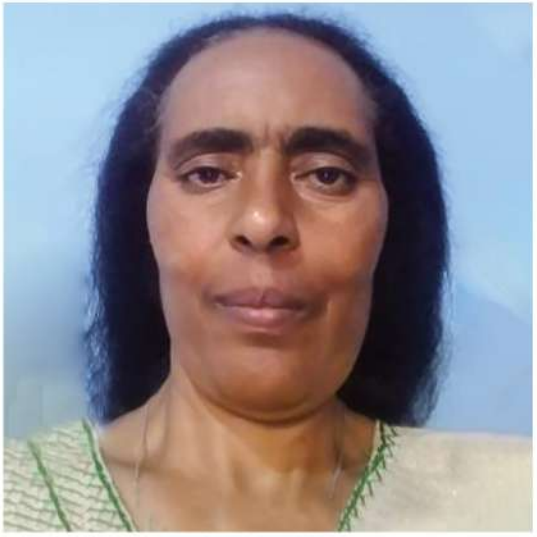
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Almaz Gizew Adugna (PhD)

AGRICULTURALIST

Almaz has B.A in Geography from Bahir Dar University, MA and PhD. from Haramaya University in Development Studies.

She has published her researches in notable journals. She was part of mega projects while she was a lecturer in Bahir Dar University. The project is now being implemented in eight universities and the Ministry of Agriculture is also using it. She has got the title of associate professor from Bahir Dar University and was nominated as exemplary female lecturer.



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Bekelech Tola Boku

AUTHOR, WRITER, TRADITIONAL MEDICINE

Bekelech is a writer and contributor on agricultural, natural medicine and food/seed security. She has published more than 30 books on traditional medicine and the use of herbs.

Her focus is home traditional medicine, animal feed, knowledge about plants to children, how to use Enjera in diverse ways and taking care of beauty and health in a traditional way.

Bethlehem Getahun Tadesse

AGRICULTURAL EXTENSION / COMMUNICATION RESEARCHER



Bethlehem has a BA degree in Sociology from Jimma University and MSc. in Developmental studies from Ambo University.

She is well experienced in Agricultural extension research, & Gender-related agricultural innovations gained through her eight years of experience at the Ethiopian Institute of Agricultural Research.

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Almaz Habtamu Mamo (DVM)

VETERINARIAN



Almaz has got her veterinary degree from Kamaway University and MSC in pathology and DVM, MSc from Addis Ababa University.

She has served her country as a veterinarian for 28 years. She has served in Bahir Dar University at various levels. She is now working in fish development projects.

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Eden Aminu Hussien

AGRIPRENEUR

Eden Aminu is a young organizational, business development and passion- oriented Engineer with special skills in effective organizational & project management, communication and team work.

Passionately driven towards her interest, she has worked as an Agripreneur working towards planning and implementing solution-oriented agricultural and renewable energy project plans for smallholder farmers of different categories from its initial build up to pack down.



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Fatuma Hanfre Handu

DEVELOPMENT / DISASTER MANAGEMENT

Fatuma received her first degree from Civil Service University and her Master's in disaster management from Semera University.

She is now serving in Women and Social Affairs Bureau as director of Women participation and mobilization Directorate. Fatuma has participated in initiatives that aim to halt female genital mutilation in the Afar region. She proudly mentioned the success stories from Afambo and Abala Weredas and seven other weredas in which female genital mutilation practices are being halt. She is also working hard to ensure the economic empowerment and political participation of women in the region.

Hulubanche Tadele Kassa

AGRICULTURAL BIOTECHNOLOGY / RESEARCHER

Hulubanche has MSc. in Molecular Biology & Biotechnology from Pan African University Institute for Basic Science Technology and innovation and Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology.

She has BSc in Biotechnology from Gondar University. Her major training was on modern breeding for potato improvement, reverse engineering, Management of Commercial tissue culture, introduction and quality laboratory management system and acclimatization of tissue culture plants.



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Kidist Fekadu Wolde (PhD)

PLANT PATHOLOGY

Kidist has PhD in Plant Pathology (Plant Disease): from Nkrumah University of Science and Technology Ghana. She has done her MSc in Plant Pathology at Hawassa University and completed her BSc in Horticulture in Jimma University.

Her major area of study revolved in integrated pest management and food safety; in-vitro plant technologies; green-house gas assessment from agricultural landscape, science-policy interaction that is making science work for policy and management. She used to work as a lecturer: Forest protection, Agroforestry Department at Wondo Genet College of Forestry and Natural Resources and was Junior instructor: Vegetable Production and Management at Dilla Agricultural Technical and Vocational Training Center.



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Mahlet Yohannes Sergawie

ADVISOR VALUE CHAIN DEVELOPMENT

Mahlet studied international business management. Gained experience in marketing and agriculture programmes implementation and value chain development.

She holds a Master of Arts Degree in International Business and Management from the Bradford University, UK and a Bachelor of Arts Degree in Business Management from the Addis Ababa University. Mahlet Yohannes experienced in marketing, value chain development. She led various agriculture projects including dairy and forestry. She has also led the development of agriculture projects. She has experience in working with and supporting private sector actors to be linked to farmers and markets and become knowledgeable, efficient, and competitive in their business. Mahlet is well experienced in working with smallholder farmers. She is driven by her wish to bring market led solutions for the cause of farmers and to bring positive changes in their lives.



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Masho Aklile Haile

PLANT SCIENCE

Masho has received her first degree in Plant science from Debre Birhan University. Her Masters' degree is in Horticulture.

She has attended post graduate course in Germany and her pre doc in Belgium. She was the head in the department of plant science of the University. She is actively working in post-harvest and urban agriculture and served as the farm manager of the agriculture College's model farm.

Mekdes Asfaw Moges

LIVESTOCK / BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

Mekdes Asfaw holds BSc in animal science and rangeland management and a Master's degree in dairy science and Business administration.

She has more than 13 years of professional experience mainly in the fields of Livestock, value chain development, private sector development, cooperatives, agro-dealership, market development, livelihood diversification and disaster risk reduction. Mekdes is currently working at SNV Ethiopia, a Netherland based NGO as senior market development advisor. Prior to joining SNV she worked in different organizations including save the children UK, ILRI and Dilla TVET.



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Meseret Gebreselama Gidey (DVM)

VETERINARIAN

Meseret works in the Ministry of Agriculture.

She has been working in the Ministry since 2015 as meat inspector and public health expert. She has experience as quality controller in ELFORA for 4 years.



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Rukya Yesuf Mohammed

RESEARCHER IN AGRICULTURE

Rukya has BA degree from Semera University and has Master's in Animal Nutrition from Hawassa University. She is now a PHD candidate of Agricultural Animal Production in Addis Ababa University.

She is a researcher in the institution she is currently working with. She is actively serving her society through consulting, preparation of training manuals and leadership trainings. She would like to see a brand breed for Afar region and has continued her research work in the area to realize her dream.



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Selamawit Alemayehu Bekele

HORTICULTURE

Selamawit received her BA in Horticulture from Mekelle University and her Master's degree from Chinwa University in China in International relations.

She is exemplary in her work and dedicated to bring about equal opportunities for all women in the region. Selamawit has worked to bring women to a leadership role and is on the process of opening training centers for women. She is also using her position to empower the women in the region she serves.

Solyana Amsalu Subuh

AGRICULTURE / BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

Solyana studied Finance, Management and Economics. She is MSc holder in Management, Economics and Consumer studies and BA holder in Finance.

Solyana has over 15 years of professional experience in market systems and other systemic approaches to development. With extensive experience and in-depth knowledge of diverse sectors, she has proven track record of testing new ideas/innovations, interventions, and achieve exceptional results and addressing critical constraints in development including policy issues. Her areas of experts include market systems development, value chains, investment and financial inclusion, risk management (including agricultural and non-agricultural insurances), leadership, project management, capacity building, partnership management, monitoring and evaluation, and finance.



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Yeshibir Aklilu Sendeke

AGRICULTURAL RESEARCHER

Yeshibir Aklilu has B.Sc. degree in natural resources management from Ambo University and a Master's degree in Soil Science from Bahir Dar University.

As a researcher at the Debre Zeit Agricultural Research Center, she has joined the Ethiopian Institute of Agricultural Research in 2016 and has worked on soil fertility and health management program at Debre Zeit Agricultural Research Center.

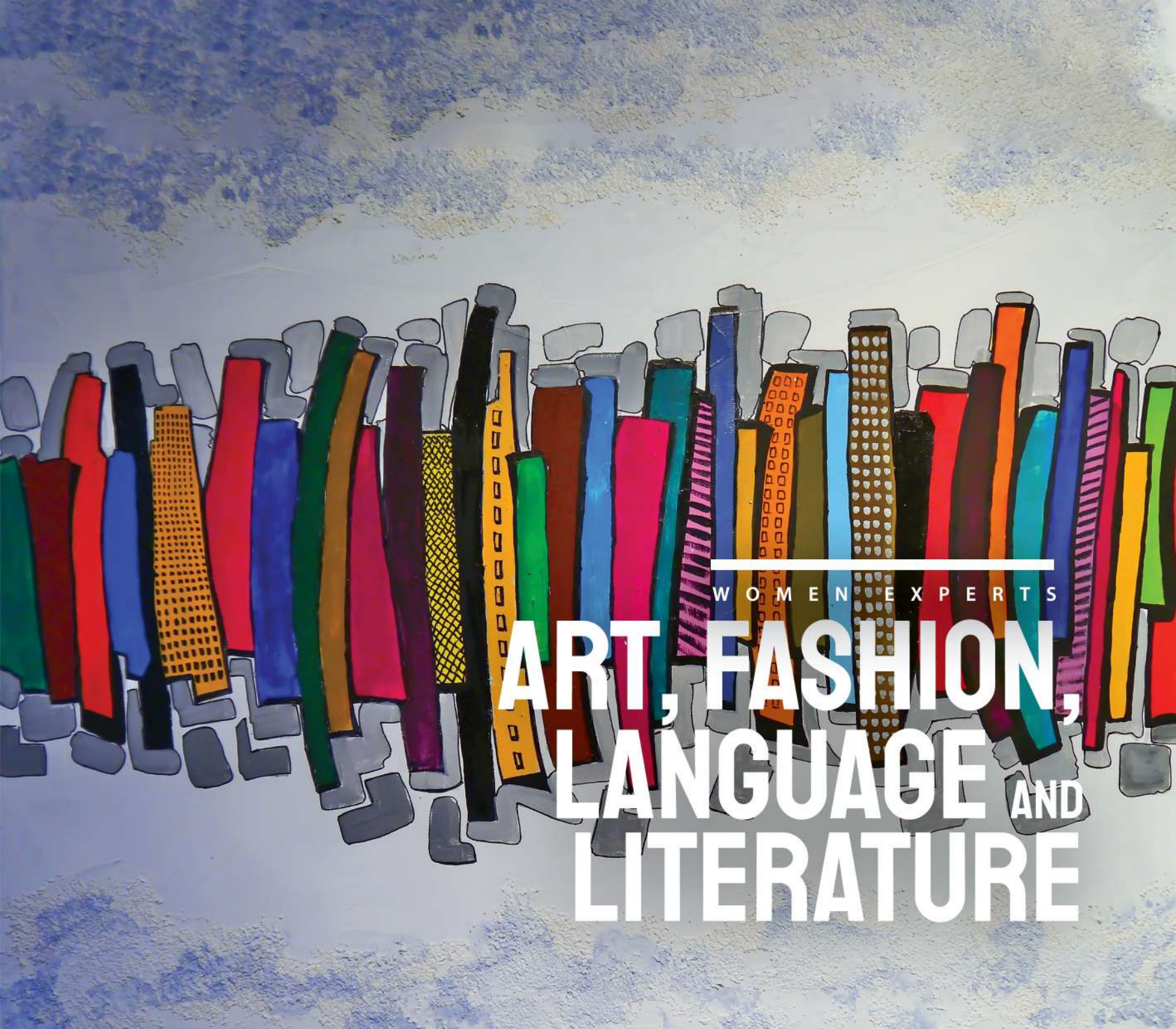


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The passion for painting was innate in me. This passion has never failed, perhaps because it has always increased with time; even today, I experience all its charm, and hope that this divine passion ends only with my life

— ÉLISABETH VIGÉE LE BRUN —

French portrait painter - especially of women; one of the foremost portraitists in Europe at the end of the eighteenth century


WOMEN EXPERTS
ART, FASHION, LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE



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Aida Tadesse Wondafrash

SOCIAL ENTREPRENEUR

Aida Tadesse is an Ethiopian Fashion Designer, and Social Entrepreneur.

She is also the President of Ethiopia Fashion Designers Industrial Sectoral Association. Aida is the Founder and Creative Director of her clothe brand AIDESHO with a motto Fashion with Purpose. Designing is her passion in life. To share her passion and her vision is the main reason behind AIDESHO. She has been in the fashion industry for several years and received many accolades. AIDESHO specializes in making women wear apparel that is made out of Ethiopian hand-woven traditional fabric by creating outstanding, timeless and functional wear that brings elegance, comfort and freedom to women's everyday wear. Furthermore, Aida has made it part of her mission to transmit, to share, to contribute in the gentlest manner possible. Her focus is on enhancing the well-being of her community of customers by giving them access to this human touch and contact. She creates offerings from Africa to Africa and to the rest of the world. She is a transmitter and a connector, as well as a provider of kind products which enhance the well-being of their wearers. She is also a community builder and teacher, hence the establishment of her initiative Teach2Impact: 10% of the proceeds from Conscious Wear by Aidesho sales go to this project which gives trainings. She also created a line called Conscious Wear in 2020 which is so dear to her heart. Conscious Wear is a slow fashion and sustainable brand for the intentional and conscious buyer.

Aynalem Ayele Chekol

FASHION DESIGNER

Aynalem has more than ten years of considerable experience in fashion design mainly focusing on cultural designs integrating contemporary styles.

Her fashion line has been displayed and presented on various notable fashion magazine, TV shows and radio programs such as Los Angeles Times, My Fashion magazine, Maraki Magazine, Fortune weekly newspaper, Addis Zemen newspaper, Ethio channel Newspaper, 120 TV show, FM98.1 and so many others. She had the honor to design a custom handbag to the former first lady of the US, Hilary Clinton. Aynalem has been awarded the best designer place in two major events. She also had participated at notable fashion weeks in Berlin, London, New Delhi, Tokyo, Nairobi, Stockholm, Washington, and Addis Ababa. She has opened her own fashion line in Ethiopia and a member of the Center for African Women Economic Empowerment, African women entrepreneurship program, Ethiopian Women Exports Association, Addis Ababa Women Entrepreneurs Association, international Women Club of Addis Ababa, United Nations Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO).



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Ejigayehu Hailegiorgis Ararso

FASHION DESIGNER

Ejiyayehu is the founder and owner of Ejig Tibeb. The company was established in 1996 that produces hand woven material for different kinds of wear. Ejig Tebeb is a company that produces high quality hand made products from Ethiopian cotton intending to promote Ethiopian hand-woven and garment products to expand the market outlet of those products.



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Meaza Worku Birhanu

CREATIVE WRITER

Meaza has received her BA in Theatre Arts from Addis Ababa University and diploma from University of West in Sweden in Intercultural Adult Pedagogy.

She has written theatres entitled "zenegnochu", "shebreb" and "keselamta gar" in Amharic and Desperate to Fight, Cross Roads and By the River, in English which were staged in Kenya, Uganda, Rwanda, Burundi, Sweden, Italy and New York. These were translated into Italian, Arabic and German languages. Her work By the River is published in a collection of theatre book entitled Lighting the Way. She has also contributed more than 20 short radio dramas and four series television dramas. She is currently, the owner and manager of Meaza film production and Art Consultancy.

Roman Tadesse Getachew

CARTOONIST

Roman Tadesse is a graduate of Graphics art from Addis Ale Arts School in Ababa University.

She has a vast experience working as a cartoonist in various private newspapers published in the country and abroad.



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Meron Sisay Abey

CREATIVE ARTS THERAPY

Meron has built international career in production, Arts in Health, diverse cultural and creative environments. Meron received a bachelor for Performing and visual Arts from Addis Ababa University, and Health and Medicine Equity in Brain Health Program from Trinity College Dublin, Ireland.

She has spearheaded the 11th UNESCO Intangible Heritages opening at Millennium Hall, and the 12th Ethiopian Nation and Nationalities Day. She also directed Engeda" Theater at Alem Cinema and "First day forth story" Hektomeron project in Romania. She has shown her talent of creative therapy through a recent research and art intervention by fighting the psychosocial impact of Covid 19 with creative arts intervention at Gefersa Mental Health Rehabilitation Center.



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Selamawit Mecca Zergaw

LITERARY SCHOLAR

Selamawit is an Assistant Professor in Ethiopian literature at Addis Ababa university.

She has been teaching and doing research on medieval Geez literature especially on the hagiographies of Ethiopian saints for the last 20 years. She has published several articles on the topic in notable journals. Currently she is working on the cultural evolution of food in medieval Geez manuscripts.



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Tigist Seife Haile

FASHION ENTREPRENEUR

Tigist is a fashion entrepreneur in a leather sector.

She is a Founder and CEO of Root in Style, a premium quality genuine leather accessory brand with an Ethiopian look which is a premium fashion leather brand made in Ethiopia for both local and international market. Tigist holds a master's degree in Marketing Management from Addis Ababa University and a bachelor's degree in Management Information System. Very passionate about her culture, Tigist reflects this in her leather products designs. Tigist Seife Haile work with a vision of empowering women by giving job opportunities by giving training to women on the job and creates jobs for them through her business.

Tigist Shiferaw

FASHION DESIGNER

Tigist has been working on the fashion industry. She is the owner and founder of TG'SH design. She modernizes the cotton hand woven fabric by designing clothes for men and women.

She has transformed the Gabi to colorful scarves and gives it a style so that it has a multifunctional purpose. She actively works to promote her design throughout Africa by participating in events such as Hub of Africa fashion week and by attending meetings such as Fashion Africa Conference.



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Tsehay Melaku gola

WRITER

Tsehay has B.A. in foreign language and Literature from Unity University and Diploma in Business Education from Addis Ababa University.

She has been called the first contemporary Ethiopian woman novelist, part of a wave of women writers who entered the literary scene in the early 1990s. She has been a teacher for 32 years and her novel writing journey lasts for more than 20 years in which she has become full time writer after retirement from her teaching job. Tsehay has published eight books: plotted on history, culture, social life and women's obstacles in the course of different generations. She has also published two books of poetry. Tsehay has received several awards for her contribution in Amharic literature.



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Wudalat Gedamu Teshale

WRITER/JOURNALIST

Wudalat has MA in English Literature and she is currently a PhD student of folklore at the Addis Ababa University.

She has extensive experience in teaching, practicing journalism, public relations and communications and as a board member of several organizations. She has authored 13 books and has written several articles on notable newspapers. She has extensive experience in teaching, practicing journalism, public relations and communications and as a board member of several organizations. She has authored 13 books and has written several articles on notable newspapers.



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Yemewodish Bekele Woldegebreal

WRITER/JOURNALIST

Yemwodish is a writer and a journalist. She has served the police newspaper as editor in chief for 26 years. After retirement she has founded an association that works for empowerment of women.

She has published ten books and six books. Currently she has her own radio show on Ahadu FM. Yemwedish was president for the Ethiopian Women Writers Association, board chair of NEWA, board member of EMWA.



WOMEN EXPERTS

BUSINESS, FINANCE AND ECONOMICS, INVESTMENT, E-COMMERCE AND MANUFACTURING



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Aster Solomon Neway

GIS ANALYST/ECONOMIST/ENTREPRENEUR

Aster is a senior GIS Analyst (IT), economist and an entrepreneur. She has ample experience in establishing and managing businesses and large- scale projects.

She has accumulated vast managerial skills through her thirty plus years of experience working in government, the private sector and as a consultant in local and international organizations. Aster is a co-founder and GM of the first GIS service company in Ethiopia, Information Systems Services (ISS), the first GIS company in the country established 26 years ago. She is the founding member and principal partner of the company. Aster has led the company successfully since its establishment in 1996 G.C. Trained as a GIS analyst, she has also provided professional services for the company. She has acquired extensive experience on handling projects as an economist and in the overall management and operation of GIS/LIS projects. She successfully managed multipurpose Land Information Systems (LIS) of Addis Ababa (1997-2000) and other cities. She has specialized in GIS for Urban application, which enables her to handle LIS projects for urban/ cadastre application. She also has experience of application of GIS and Remote Sensing techniques for Master Plan Project. Aster also owns and directs The Mosaic Hotel, in Addis Ababa. In addition, Aster serves as GM of a private school, New English Private School (NEPS) which is a family-owned school that spans from pre-KG to high school. NEPS currently has eight branches in Addis Ababa and its student body is made up of local and international students. She is also one of the founders of Enat Bank and served on the Board of Director for six years. - Served as a board member of Addis Ababa Chamber - President of A.A. Hotel Owners Association - A founding board member of GISSE (GIS Society of Ethiopia) - A founding member of AWIB and FCBC - Board member of ECDD (Ethiopian Centre for Disability Development).

Azeb Assefa Gudissa

MARKETING CONSULTANT



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Azeb has over 16 years of professional experience in the field of Marketing.

She is a marketing professional and a graduate from Addis Ababa University in Marketing Management fields she has obtained MA-Marketing Management Education (AAU), BSc. Business Education- Marketing and Sales Management (AAU), Higher Diploma in Teaching Methods (AAU) and Diploma in Secretarial Science and Office Management from AACC. She was also a founding member and Gen. Secretary of Ethiopian Marketing Professionals Association and served over 6 years in the educational sector as lecturer of Marketing and Sales Management courses. Apart from involving in the educational sector, by co-founding a marketing service provider firm; Axis Marketing Services PLC, she is currently engaged as a Managing Director. She has been delivering professional marketing-based supports services like strategic marketing management, market competitiveness, profit growth, branding, communication, promotion, customer satisfaction, market expansion strategies and marketing, business development and entrepreneurial trainings for companies and various programs in Ethiopia. In addition, she has also proven entrepreneurial achievement by leading a nutritional food processing company 'Yiblu Foods' founded by herself in 2012, which is now grown to investment capacity and under constructing its factory. She was winner of Food and Nutrition, GIZ Green Innovation Slam 2018.



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Elleni Daniel Gebreyesus

PROJECT PLANNER/MANAGER

Elleni is an event organizer, plastic manufacturing owner, life skill trainer, and life coach. She created favorable enabling environment for women unpaid workers in her plastic manufacturing.

She helped her female employees to find healthy perception among themselves, closed the isolation gap between coworkers helping them come together and combine their strongest skills. Elleni has Masters in Business Administration, Masters in Project Planning and Management and BA in Management and Diploma in Accounting. Elleni has been working for 20 years in different NGOs as project manager.



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Haregewoin Mirotaw Shumye

INVESTMENT ADVISOR

Haregewoin has BSc degree in Statistics and MSc in Population Studies.

She has attended more than 25 short term trainings related with investment promotion, leadership, project management, information security basics & technology and SPSS in Ethiopia and abroad. She has a job experience of 15 years as Investment Information Expert, Investment Data Analyst, Investment Information Team Leader and Investment Information and Technology Directorate Director. Currently, she is a Director, Investment Promotion & Marketing Directorate in Ethiopian Investment Commission.

Jaleli Assefa Bekele

INFRASTRUCTURE INVESTMENT ADVISOR

Jaleli is competent investment professional with a demonstrated history of working in investment transaction advisory and infrastructure investment management for the past five years.

She has broad industry experience that includes; energy, digital Infrastructure, healthcare, real estate, manufacturing, and hospitality industry. She is a motivated professional focused on applying business acumen and project management skills to accomplish project milestones according to a specific timeline.



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Maedot Assefa Kebede

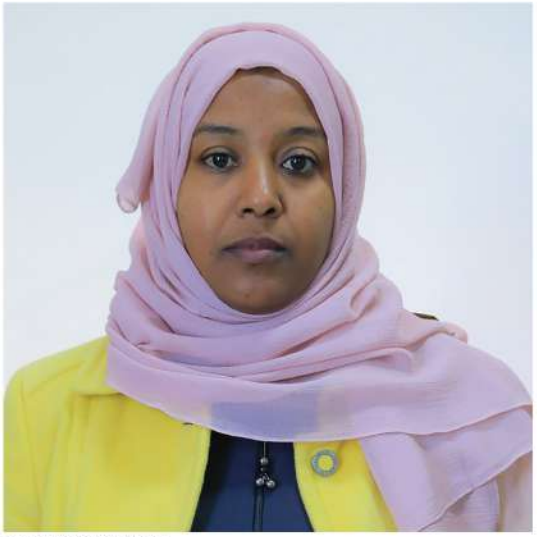
DIGITAL BUSINESS/ E-COMMERCE

Maedot has MA in International Service Management from Stenden University, Leeuwarden Netherland and BA in Tourism Management from Gondar University.

Her major training includes ADBL executive diploma in digital business, corporate social responsibility and introduction to E-Commerce. She is the founding member of Rotary Club, Interact Club of Hillal, Addis Ababa



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Muna Jemal Redi

BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

Muna has attended Haramaya university and got accreditation in Agribusiness managements and has 15 years' work experiences in Business development service.



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Radi Ali Kulay

BUSINESS OWNER

Radi has diploma in Nursing from Semera Health College and has worked as an officer in DKT Ethiopia. She has received her bachelor's degree in Business Management and started a private business in the construction sector. Radi has established animal posts, health posts and schools in areas where such infrastructure was nonexistent.

She is well experienced in constructing basic infrastructure through her own constriction company, she has a plan to expand her expertise in infrastructure building in the agricultural sector as well. Radi is now pursuing her Master's in Business management in Semera University.

Tiringo Dinku Abeje [PhD]

ACCOUNTING/FINANCE

Tiringo is Assistant professor in the accounting and finance department of the College of Business and Economics.

She has got her BA from Debre Birhan University and completed her PHD in accounting and finance. She has published her research works in renowned journals. She also serves as board member in real estates and share companies in Bahir Dar town.



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Give yourself a high five! The best way to start is by high fiving yourself every time you pass a mirror. The simple habit of high fiving yourself with start to clear the negative crap in your head and make room for all of that innate, natural self-love, wisdom, courage and confidence you were born with

— **MEL ROBBINS** —

American podcast host, author, motivational speaker, and former lawyer.
She is known for her TEDx talk, "How to Stop Screwing Yourself Over"; and her books,
The 5 Second Rule and The High 5 Habit, as well as host of The Mel Robbins Podcast



WOMEN EXPERTS

COUNSELING AND PSYCHOLOGY



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Metasebia Mammo Desta

PSYCHOLOGIST

Metasebia is a psychologist by profession. She has BA in psychology and a Masters in Sociology.

She worked on vulnerable children and communities in both government and non- government organizations. She has started her career working in a center for Juvenile delinquents as a guidance and counseling officer forty years ago. Thereafter she worked as a counselor and coordinator of social services in GOs, a psychosocial support technical specialist in International NGO's, an executive director, manager and a trainer in NGOs, a consultant and a manager in private sector and she is a trained Montessorian. She has been running a kindergarten for more than twelve years in my community and now run a community day care center called best day care, that follows Montessori methodology. She has a certificate in Montessori Education from March 2018 –May 2019 from Water Park Institute, Norway, she is one of the lead trainers in national daycare assistant training and on parenting training and counseling.



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Yefrezer Gezahegn Nigussie

PSYCHIATRIST

Yefrezer is a psychiatrist interested in health promotion and justice in health care (especially mental health). She is also a volunteer at yetena weg.

Betselot Endaylalu Merin

PSYCHOLOGIST

Betselot has Master's degree in Social Psychology from Addis Ababa University and has received her Bachelor of Arts in Psychology from Wolaita Sodo University.

She has worked with international and local NGOs to support the refugee community and sexually abused children for eight years. She has extensive experience as a child protection counselor for refugee children and their families in providing overall psychosocial support (including MHPSS and SGBV cases) counseling, as well as training. In 2020, she founded the Child Well-being Media Center Charitable Organization, an NGO dedicated to child protection and GBV. In addition, the organization assists abused children by providing psychosocial support and media advocacy.



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Mastewal Mekonnen Seyeneh (PhD)

COUNSELOR/PSYCHOLOGIST

Mastewal is an Assistant Professor at Addis Ababa University, School of Psychology and a Member of the House of Peoples' Representatives of the FDRE.

She had been working as an Assistant Professor of Mental Health and School Counseling at South Eastern Oklahoma State University (U.S.A). She has an interdisciplinary educational background from different universities: counselor education and supervision (Ph.D.), youth and family development (MA), public health and society (M.Sc.), social psychology (MA), psychology (BA) from USA, the Netherlands, and Ethiopia. Mastewal has more than 15 years of work experience in teaching, research, counseling, and leadership.



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Strategies for research & policy development must simultaneously address people's needs, the capacity of programs to provide good quality of care, and the range of technological options available

— **RUTH SIMMONS**—

American Professor and Academic Administrator



WOMEN EXPERTS

DEVELOPMENT AND POLICY



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Aster Birke Asfaw

CIVIL SOCIETY CONSULTANT

Aster has over 25 years of multi-sectoral experience in the civic sector in Ethiopia and Lesotho. Her sectoral expertise includes governance, conflict mitigation & peacebuilding, women's empowerment and gender inclusion, HIV/AIDS, reproductive health, livelihood, and vulnerable children.

She has worked on system strengthening – developing capacities of civil society organizations (CSOs), government institutions and communities at federal and regional levels in Ethiopia, and abroad. Aster is an experienced trainer and facilitator. She has undertaken research; she has helped to found several civil society organizations and serves on various CSO boards on voluntary basis. She is currently a freelance consultant – her sectoral focus being democracy/governance, peacebuilding, system strengthening and women's empowerment. She has a BSc. and MBA in management.



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Aynalem Abreham Desta

HUMANITARIAN/DEVELOPMENT

Aynalem is a Project, Program, Grants & Operations Management Specialist who is practical, results-oriented, and vision- driven professional with over 18 years of proven experience in the Development & Humanitarian interventions, having MA in Organizational Management &Finance from University of London.

Proven experience in strategic development and program design, planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation; competent manager with considerable knowledge of working and theoretical knowledge of Operations Management Passionate about aligning business interests with development objectives, leveraging donor resources with commercial assets and vice versa, hence interventions are impactful & inclusive.

Bethelehem Tenkir Gebresenbet

GENDER AND HUMAN RIGHTS, ADVOCATE



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Bethelehem has a Master's Degree from the Ethiopian Graduate School of Theology, on Development Studies focusing on Theology, Gender and Health. In addition, she has studied for her Masters of Science on Multidisciplinary studies from the State University of New York (SUNY). She is trained Psycho Social issues in Humanitarian settings and acquainted with the Core Humanitarian Standard.

She has worked with civil society organizations in project management, implementations and in leadership positions for national and regional NGOs. On the projects she was leading, she has implemented, coordinated the full project cycle including on site evaluations and coaching stakeholders of the projects. Bethelehem has spearheaded one of the biggest projects in Ethiopia called Ethiopian Social Accountability Phase II, which was widely implemented by the World Bank's Protection of Basic Services (PBS). She had led advocacy campaigns such as the 16 days activism against Gender Based violence using the country's media and engagements with government and CSOs working on the issue. She had also worked as a lead consultant on the research conducted to identify the potentials of ratifying the Maputo Protocol to Ethiopia's context. She had also worked as a Gender specialist for UNICEFF's initiative called "design and manage the Inception phase of the roadmap to realize the London Girls' Summit Commitment to end Child marriage and FGM/C by 2025". Bethelehem has been trained on the "Gender in Leadership and Decision making" by the International Institute of Rural Reconstruction, "Women's economic, social and cultural rights" by PWESCR, "Gender Responsive Right Based approach" by DEVCO.



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Bezawit Girma Lemeso

DEVELOPMENT

Bezawit has a PhD in Applied management and has worked as Secretary General for the Ethiopian National Commission for UNESCO.

Currently she is working as a director at Construction Professional Development Institute.



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Eden Tsegaye Mamo

PUBLIC POLICY/ PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION SPECIALIST

Eden is a public policy and public administration consultant with five years of experience in being embedded in public institutions with a focus on supporting capacity building, policy and strategy development and also implementation across different sectors in Ethiopia and Rwanda.

She is currently embedded at Ministry of Health, Rwanda advising on the performance management system in the sector, and supporting the implementation of key interventions in specific priorities including reducing maternal mortality. Prior to moving to Rwanda, Eden supported key public institutions including the Prime Minister's Office and Jobs Creation Commission in developing and implementing policies, strategies and interventions on investment attraction, export promotion, and job creation sectors. Eden is passionate about improving governance in Africa and building the capacity of public institutions to improve development outcomes. She holds an MSC in international development; public policy and management from The University of Manchester.

Fanaye Gebrehiwot Feleke

DEVELOPMENT/GENDER



Fanaye has a background in Law, Development and Gender and has been working in academia and the development sector for the past 16 years.

She has worked in the development sector with a focus on Gender Equality and Social Equity, Building Resilient and Sustainable livelihoods through market based and climate smart approaches and Local Governance issues. She is currently working as the Country Director and Senior Expert-Gender and social Equity of Helvetas Swiss Inter cooperation.

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Lidya Tesfaye Ayalew

RESEARCHER



Lidya is a research officer at Alliance International Bioversity-CIAT. She is also a finance and development economist, development practitioner, gender equality advocate and a proud Rotaractor.

As an Ethiopia project associate, she has worked closely with Precision Agriculture for Development (PAD) team members and other partner organizations to execute implementations of projects. She also supervised and coordinated qualitative and quantitative data collection (including farmer focus groups, interviews, surveys), data cleaning and analysis, and writing reports. She works with researchers to ensure that projects adhere to polices procedures and timelines.

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Meaza Nega Hagos

DEVELOPMENT/MONITORING AND EVALUATION

Meaza is a passionate evidence-based development practitioner. She was a senior gender researcher for Includovate, worked for iDE as a Monitoring and Evaluation Officer, and then was promoted to Monitoring and Evaluation Manager within four years of working at iDE. She has held various roles including Economist and Planning and Evaluation Officer at Addis Ababa Water and Sewerage Authority. She has experience in Human-Centered Design and quantitative evaluations and is passionate about gender equality. She holds a Master of Science in Environmental Planning and Management from UNESCO-IHE Institute based in Delft, Netherlands; and a Bachelor of Arts degree in Economics from Haramaya University, Ethiopia. Her core competencies are quantitative evaluation, feasibility study, gender analysis, MEL plan development, impact assessment, program management and Domain expertise.

Mekdes Gebrewold Hundura

LEADERSHIP/MANAGEMENT



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Mekdes is a strategic management advisor, leadership enthusiast and active young leader with more than a decade of experience in community service and active leadership in Ethiopia. She is now a PhD candidate in Mediation and Conflict Resolution at Euclid University.

She has got her first Bachelor of Arts (BA) followed by her Master of Arts in Leading Innovation and Change from York St. John University. She is an internationally certified leadership consultant from John C. Maxwell Leadership Institute in Florida. Currently, she is granted a scholarship with United Nations Institute of Training and Research to be certified in Executive Diplomacy in Geneva, Switzerland. Mekedes is now consulting more than 12 organizations in Ethiopia. She is also a national consultant for UNWomen in coaching FDRE women executives. Mekdes is a founder and managing director of Ashagari Consultancy, a management solution firm and Ashagari charitable organization. Through her training and consultancy, she directly trained more than 130,000 people in Ethiopia.



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Meyru Humed Ali

DEVELOPMENT WORKER

Meyri has diploma in Home Economics from an Agricultural College and BA in Social Science from Panjer University in India.

She was serving as planning expert in the Agriculture Bureau gender affairs office. She served in a project called BESO with USAID for two years and became member of the parliament representing Afar Region. After a term of five years, she started an NGO that focused on digging out water in the region. She is now working with a Netherlands based NGO that works for advancing education among pastoralist communities.



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Seada Mohammed Awol

DEVELOPMENT WORKER

Seada was born in Assayita special name Sehale.

She has completed her diploma in animal science from Jimma University and got her bachelor's degree from Haramaya University in the same field of study. She has served in different positions for the last 14 years. She has got her Master's degree in Cooperative Marketing from Mekelle University. She was engaged in several initiatives that empower the financial capacity of women. As a technical assistant to UNFP she is trying to stop harmful traditional practices in Afar region such as female genital mutilation and early marriage.

Selamawit Woldegebriel Enna

FOOD SECURITY/AGRICULTURE/POLICY ANALYSIS



Selamawit has been working in the areas of food security and agriculture. She has experience in policy analysis , strategic leadership, projects and program management, inclusive economic growth , social development, community behavior change models and practice.

She also has experience in applying holistic approaches to ending child marriage and other harmful traditional practices, advocacy and women's reproductive health rights. She has the capacity to advise on cooperative development and gender equality, women and entrepreneurship, large scale program coordination and implementation including strategic engagement with government and key stakeholders such as international NGOs and local partners at all levels from district to sub regional level.

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Soleyana Shimeles Gebremichael

LAWYER/POLICY ADVOCACY/COMMUNICATION



Soleyana is a lawyer and policy expert by training. She was one of the founders of the Zone Nine bloggers, a group formed by Ethiopian online activist's blogging on human rights and democracy issues since 2012.

She also coordinated the Ethiopia Human Rights Project (EHRP), a project which seeks to bolster the advocacy work done by domestic and international actors to advance human rights in Ethiopia. Soleyana has international experience on advocacy, democratization, and policy research. She was charged under the country's former Anti-Terrorism Proclamation as a lead defendant and she got back to Ethiopia after five years of political exile and joined the reforming National Election Board of Ethiopia (NEBE), as a communications Advisor and Spokesperson. She led the credibility and transparency strategic pillar of the organization for three years before she left the NEBE. She is currently an independent consultant.

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Zewdie Abegaz Yimam

COMMUNICATION/LEADERSHIP/GENDER

Zewdie has twenty-five-year career working in UNICEF for women's advancement in Ethiopia, following nine years working in Ethiopian government Ministries in radio programming and in promoting family life education; involved in the preparation of women's national policy and constitution; prepared manuals on gender auditing, mainstreaming, and gender analysis and trained many men and women in government and in civil society in bringing gender concerns and analysis to the forefront of their work.

She was involved in civil society's works as a general assembly and board member/chair as well as contributing professional advice, leadership, and policy ideas on the welfare of children and women. Zewdie was able to contribute to a progressive women's policy promulgated by the Transitional Government in 1993, to contribute to progressive language on women's and children's rights in the Constitution adopted in 1995, and to train many government and non-government leaders in gender-sensitive development practices during her long career. She has Bachelor's Degree in Mass Communication and Social Science, and master's degree in Educational Administration. Zewdie has received numerous certificates, letters of appreciation, gifts from ministries, international organizations, regional governments, NGOs, religious organizations, civil societies, and farmer's and women's associations. Enat Bank, initiated by some of Ethiopia's leading businesswomen, named one of its branches in her name.

WOMEN EXPERTS

DISABILITY





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Dibabe Bacha Degefu

DISABILITY ADVOCATE

Dibabe is Executive Directress of Ethiopian women with disability national association and a founder and member of Sexual and Gender Based Violence women movement campaign led by Network of Ethiopian Women's Association(NEWA),
she is board member in Ethiopian Disability Action Network, an advisory committee member in Ethiopian Civil Society and executive committee in Ethiopian civil society organization national counsel, member in African Women in dialogue, East African Women Human Rights Defender and Ministry of Labor and Social Affairs Ethiopian Disability Act draft committee, and Ministry of Labor and Social Affairs report organizer committee.

Currently, she is a General Manager at Ethiopian Women with Disabilities National Association and as a leader and a woman with disability herself. Dibabe has led disability movement campaigns, met with Addis Ababa Mayor and decision makers and lobby for inclusive service delivery, and advocate for women with disability rights. She is a woman with disability who, despite facing multifaced challenged in her country, surpassed challenges and used them as an opportunity to grow and be an advocate for all persons with disability to exercise their human rights fully.

Firehiwot Siyum Taddesse

DISABILITY ADVOCATE



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Firehiwot is intersectional disability advocate (self-advocate) from Ethiopia who has extensive experiences in disability inclusion, gender mainstreaming, youth participation at national, continental, and international level, including in the UN system.

She is currently Project Officer at the African Disability Forum (ADF) for the "We are Able!" project in Ethiopia, advocating for disability inclusive food security programs and policies. In addition, she led on and provided technical support for ADF's initiatives on Gender, Youth and Inclusion, including the Young African Women with Disabilities Leadership Program, the first in its kind pilot program that aimed at increasing and improving meaningful representation of young African women with disabilities in leadership and decision making. Before joining ADF in November 2021, Firehiwot worked at the H.Q. of the ILO in Geneva, as Jr. Gender Equality Officer, and Jr. Technical Officer on disability inclusion. She has working experiences in Ethiopia, Ghana, the U.S. and Switzerland. Firehiwot earned her Master's in Disability Studies from Syracuse University in New York, with Scholarship award from Open Society Foundations. She was also an awardee of Open Society Foundations' Civil Society Professional Program and is an alumna of the Young African Leaders Initiatives (YALI) RLC East Africa.



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Mihret Nigussie Chengere

DISABILITY ADVOCATE/WOMEN RIGHTS

Mihret is an immediate past President of Federation of Ethiopian National Association of Person with Disabilities, because of this position she has been advocating for the rights of more than 20million people with disabilities in Ethiopia.

She is also current President of Fikir Ethiopian National Association on Intellectual Disabilities. Mihret is also a chairperson to Advisory committee of Ethiopian Women Human Right Defenders Network. She is also one of the founder and current President of Special Olympics Ethiopia -which is a sport federation focusing on people with Intellectual Disabilities. Mihret got Postgraduate in Development Management program, another MA in Project Management and Bachelor's Degree in Management Information System from different universities. She is one of the fellows of BRIDGE CRPD-SDG Disability right movement for East-West Africa. Mihret has a total of more than 15 years' work experience as Executive director, Program Manager, Team lead, Project officer & Trainer (i.e. social and economic development issues including Knowledge management, Disabilities Right, UNCRPD, SDG, GBV, Sex workers, and HIV/AIDS) with in NGOs and Organizations of People with disability. Mihret is a proud Rotarian full time volunteer who believed in 'Service above self'. Apart from all the above volunteer leadership contribution, she is also working with Inclusion Africa as an Inclusive Education Regional Program Coordinator and this work engaged her to advocate for the rights of people with intellectual disability at Africa regional level specifically within 23 African countries.

Rigbe Gebrehawaria

LAWYER/DISABILITY ADVOCATE/ SOCIAL WORKER



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Rigbe is a diversity and inclusion advocate with over 14 years' experience, working on disability rights and gender justice through research, advocacy, project management, training and human resource management.

She is a Mandela Washington Fellow and has served in the East Africa Regional Advisory Board for the Mandela Washington Fellowship. She holds a Master of Social Work and a Bachelor of Laws. Besides having a physical disability, herself, Rigbe developed interest towards disability rights advocacy after working for a Non-Governmental Organization on the Inclusion of Persons with Disabilities, which exposed her to issues and challenges faced by Persons with Disabilities in general and Women with Disabilities in particular. Rigbe was also involved in her own private practice carrying out social consultancy for vulnerable groups focusing on Disability Inclusion. She is currently working as the Commissioner for Disability Rights and Rights of Older Persons at the Ethiopian Human Rights Commission. Prior to that, she worked at the U.S. Embassy Addis Ababa as a Senior HR Assistant and Disabilities Advisor. As part of her voluntary activities, Rigbe has worked as a legal aid counselor at the Ethiopian Women Lawyers Association (EWLA) and a project facilitator for non-governmental organizations working on disability inclusion. She is currently an expert member of the Working Group on the Rights of Older Persons and Persons with Disabilities in Africa. She is a board member of the Strategic Initiative for Women in the Horn of Africa (SIHA Network), co-founder and board member of the Ethiopian Lawyers with Disabilities Association, co-founder and board chair of Setawit NGO, and a board member of Eyu-Ethiopia. She has served as a board chair of the Ethiopian Women Lawyers Association (EWLA), a member of the National Experts Board/Advisory Group of the Resource and Support Hub Program and a member of the UN Women Civil Society Organizations Advisory Group.



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Shitaye Astawes Banteyikasegn

DISABILITY ADVOCATE

Shitaye has BA Degree in Foreign Language and Literature (Non-teaching/Journalism) and MA Degree in Gender Studies both from Addis Ababa University in Ethiopia.

She has also earned Diploma in Mainstreaming Disability Equality in the World of Work as well as Certificate in Gender Mainstreaming Training from the International Labor organization's Training Center (ITC) in Turin, Italy. Shitaye has more than twenty years of work experience in disability rights advocacy and promotion of disability inclusive development programs of different organizations. She has served the Federation of Ethiopian Associations of persons with Disabilities (FEAPD) at the capacities of Training Officer and executive Director, the Austrian Development Agency (ADA) as its National Program Manager and Team Leader for the global project bridging the Gap II (BtG II): Inclusive Policies and Services for Equal Rights of Persons with Disabilities. She is also serving as facilitator of disability awareness sessions and trainer of different capacity building training programs of mainstream development programs and projects of several development partners, international nongovernmental institutions, governmental institutions and advocacy groups. Shitaye is an Alumni of Bridge CRPD-SDGs West-East Africa capacity building program which is lead and coordinated by the International Disability Alliance (IDA) and advocate for the rights of persons with disabilities in general and the rights of women with disabilities in particular. Currently she is working for the African Disability Forum (ADF) at the capacity of Director for Advocacy and Communication and oversees the proper implementation of Young African Women with Disabilities Leadership Program; and she is also the Board chair for Ethiopian Center for Disability and Development (ECDD).

Tigist Alemayehu Tiruneh

DISABILITY ADVOCATE



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Tigist is an advocate on disability inclusion, deaf sign language, deaf culture.

She is a deaf advocate. Her deafness has no limitation in her life. Her educational back ground and work experience helped her to be in the disability movement. She has BA degree in Ethiopian sign language and deaf culture and an MA in Special Needs Education from Addis Ababa University. She was the former director of Association of the Deaf (ENAD). She has volunteered to convince the government to give the right for the deaf community to drive cars and succeeded. Since January 2022, she has joined Teki paper bags as a project manager. She has found an NGO to help children living with disabilities through innovative, inclusive education programs. She is now a board member at Light for the World global.

One child, one teacher, one book, one pen can change the world

— **MALALA YOUSAFZAI** —

Female education activist and
the 2014 Nobel Peace Prize laureate


WOMEN EXPERTS
EDUCATION



Abeba Amare GebreSillassie (PhD)

LITERATURE/LANGUAGE RESEARCHER

Abeba is an instructor and Researcher in English Literature at Addis Ababa University. Her research interest is literature, culture, gender and media studies.

She is the director of grievance handling office at Addis Ababa University. She was head for department of culture and social studies and head gender office of Institute of Language Studies. She has several research papers related to representation of women in the Arts.

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Agaredech Jemaneh Gemeda (PhD)

LANGUAGE/LITERATURE/JOURNALISM

Agaredech has received BA in Ethiopian Languages and Literature and MA in English Literature from Addis Ababa University.

She holds a PhD in Sociology. She has worked as a journalist at Addis Zemen Newspaper and was the senior assistant instructor for the former Ethiopian Mass Media Institute which was the first school of journalism in Ethiopia. Currently, she is an assistant professor at school of journalism and communication at Addis Ababa University.

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Frewoyni Yilma Gezahegn

EDUCATOR/PUBLIC HEALTH



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Frewoyni is a lecturer in the College of Social Sciences at Semera University.

She has BA in public health and Master's in MPH. She has served in Dubti Hospital and Aysayita Health center for ten years in reproductive health. It was a challenge for her to work in these institutions in a society that does not value women in such positions but she has secured their trust through her hard work. She has served as a lecturer in Semera University in the college of social sciences for the last seven years. She is engaged in activities that focus towards prevention of gender-based violence.

Gelila Tadesse Hunde

SPECIAL NEEDS EDUCATOR



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Gelila has been serving the Ethiopian Deaf Community for the last 23 years. She provided several educational and vocational training to the community and established and set up a vocational center.

She is the first to start a feeding program in two deaf schools in Addis Ababa. She worked with four deaf schools, providing educational and vocational supplies raising awareness and linking the schools to local and international NGOs. She also produced sign language DVDs for vocational training center and for hearing parents and families with deaf children. Gelila is now working at the Geneva International School extended support program.



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Genet Abera Demissie

LANGUAGE/LITERATURE

Genet is a University Lecturer in the English Language department at Dire Dawa University for the past 5 years.

She also served as the head of the department. Despite her duty at the University, Genet involves in various volunteering activities in the university and the city. Among the activities, she facilitated English language proficiency test preparation training in collaboration with the British Council for 20 female staff of the university. She also provided personal development training for female Dire Dawa secondary school students. Additionally, she has served as a deputy chairperson of the Academia women's network. Since 2020 Genet is serving as a volunteer to teach the English language at US Embassy Dire Dawa American space corner further to this she is part of a program on youth empowerment concerning their personal development. She has been recognized by the embassy for her achievements. Currently, she is a personal development trainer of young people, with EMG consulting. She is a certified Master trainer by the Master Card Foundation in collaboration with the Ministry of labor and skills and the American College of Technology.

Haregewoin Geresu Blru

EDUCATOR

Haregewoin is an education specialist and has ample experience of more than 18 years in the Ethiopian education sector.

She has opened her school in 2005 aiming to give needy children quality education rooted in basic life values. Haregewoin has always been driven by a passion for the poor. The school has a status of ""sole proprietorship ". It invests back to the community and is located in the Gofa community. Some of the programs the school involves are a full sponsorship program, a feeding program, Mother's health coverage, and adult literacy. She has been teaching an average of 500 students every year, giving them all the quality education, they deserve. Haregewoin has involved in training teachers and school Administrators in self and job development for the last eight years.



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Medina Humed Abdella

EDUCATOR/PUBLIC HEALTH

Medina has got her BSC in Nursing from Semera University and her Master's in MPH.

She is currently serving as a lecturer in Nursing at Semera University. Medina participates in community activities, engages in research and provides tutorial classes for female students apart from her main job as a lecturer. She has 8 children as she starts marriage at the age of 18 and serves as a role model for not stopping her dreams of education despite her responsibilities as a mother and as a wife.



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Melatwork Tibebu Mengesha

EDUCATOR/CLINICAL LABORATORY SCIENTIST/WOMEN EMPOWERMENT

Melatwork is a Lecturer at Addis Ababa University, Department of Medical Laboratory Science with more than 10 years of experience.

She has BSc degree in Medical Laboratory Science and MSc degree in Clinical Laboratory Science, Hematology and Immunohematology Specialty track. Melatwork has served as the coordinator of the extension program and chairperson for the department research ethics and review committee. Melatwork has published research papers in international peer reviewed journals and currently working on multiple manuscripts for publication. Besides earning many certificates in continuous professional development trainings, she has also attended short term leadership, advocacy, peace and security training including leadership in public management at YALI RLC EA. She spends her free time by volunteering for youth empowerment organizations such as YALDA where she served as writer and content creation coordinator for the publicity and communications team. She also served as the Chairperson of the YALI RLC alumni chapter of Ethiopia. Melatwork founded her own non-profit women empowerment and mentorship program in 2019 that trained and certified young women in leadership and personal development courses to help them be efficient in their professional as well as personal lives. In 2022, She was selected to participate at the AU-EU summit in Brussels as a youth rapporteur representing YALDA. Melatwork hopes to contribute to policy making in the higher education and health sectors that will make a positive sustainable impact for her country.

Meretech Shiferaw Kibret

LANGUAGE/LITERATURE

Meretech is an English language instructor in Arba Minch University and currently she is a PhD Candidate.

She has considerable work experience as English language skill trainer. she gave the training called ELIP (English Language Improvement Program) organized by British council in collaboration with Ministry of education and she was a TOT for the training called TELL (Teach English for Life Learning) which was prepared by USAID in collaboration with the Ministry of Education and American Institutes for Research. She also prepared and developed Multimedia Based Learning and Teaching Supplementary Package (MBLTSP) for English, Grade 1 and 2 students. She also served as a gender focal in Dilla University.



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Meron Zeleke Eresso (PhD)

EDUCATOR/GENDER SPECIALIST/RESEARCHER

Meron is an Associate Professor who has extensively researched and published on various gender related issues in Ethiopia and the Horn of Africa regions. She has years of teaching and research experience at renowned academic institutions in Africa, North America, Europe and Asia, and is a member of several international academic associations.

She has rich research experience on numerous international and national academic research projects. Her core research expertise is in areas of migration, gendered labor markets, violence against women, religion, and customary conflict resolution. Meron has extensively published in internationally renowned peer-reviewed journal on a wide range of topics. She has authored books, edited volumes and journals, contributed chapters to several edited volumes and entries in encyclopedias including the oxford research encyclopedia of African history. She is an international editorial board member of Islamic Africa (Brill) and the Editor in Chief of the Ethiopian Journal of Human Rights. She has received several international awards and grants for her researches. She is one of the few African prominent scholars included in Academia.Net, the platform for selected female scientists around the globe recognized for their research and publications. She has also been featured on BBC with a special focus on her research on gender issues in the horn of Africa.

Rebecca Tadesse Hunde

EDUCATOR/COMMUNICATION/MEDIA



Rebecca is solution- focused education and communication specialist who has more than 20 years of experience in media, communication and education, and educational management.

She has worked in different media houses in Ethiopia and abroad as a photographer, reporter, editor, editor-in-chief and publisher of the first bilingual monthly sports magazine, and she a teacher and school manager. She received her Master of Arts in Ethiopian Studies with specialization in Museology, BA in broadcast journalism and communication, BA in English Literature from Addis Ababa University as well as a diploma in educational administration and management from the Asian College of Teachers and a Diploma in Media studies from Oslo University. She is also a certified fact-checker. Rebecca is serving as chair-person for the Ethiopian Media Women Association executive board.

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Zebiba Musema Kedir

EDUCATOR/LAWYER



Zebiba has a background in Law and specialized in International Economic and Business Law (L.L.M) and MA in Development Management.

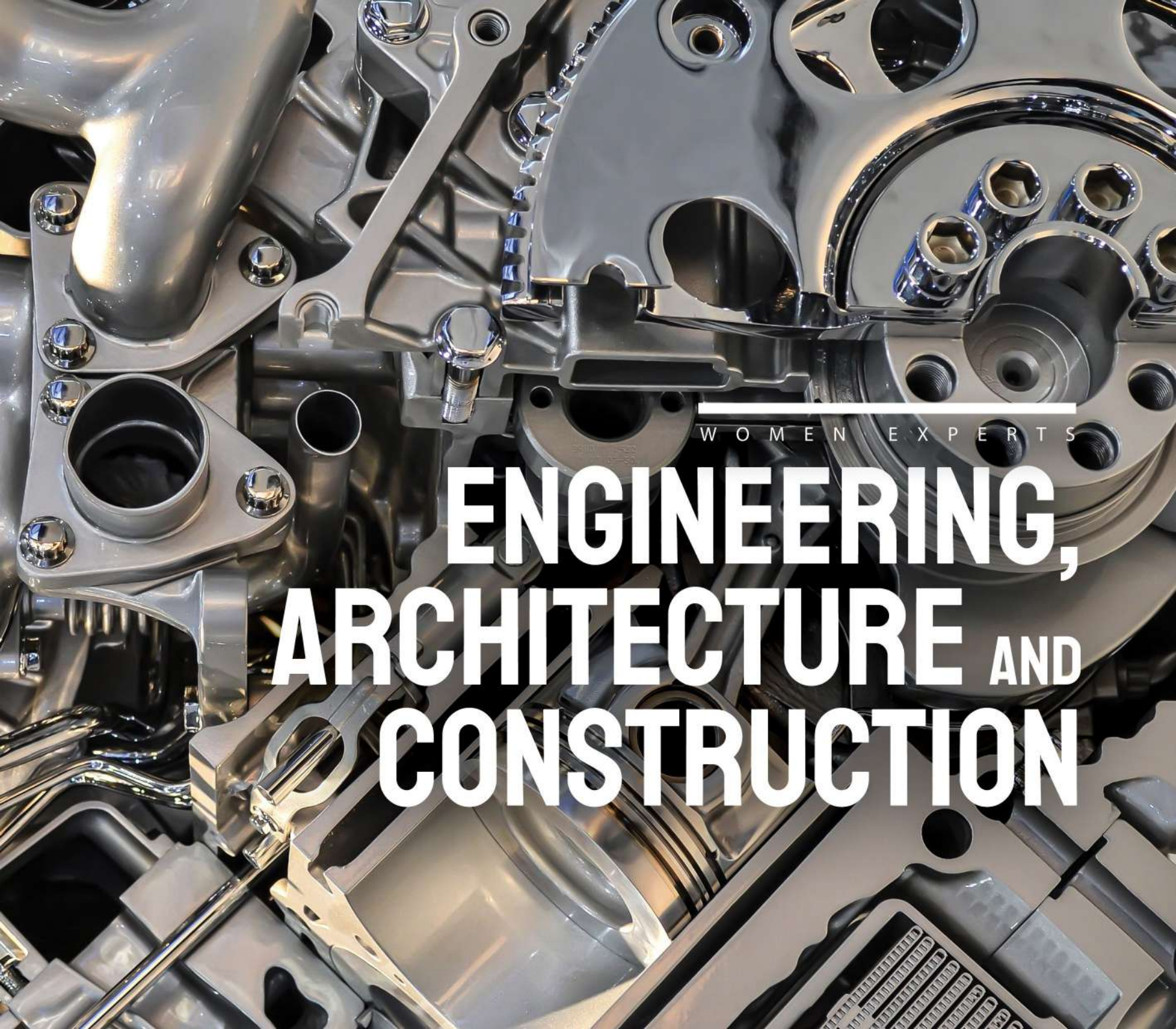
She is the Program Coordinator of Addis Ababa University, Center for Human rights, and Part-time Program Coordinator of U.S. embassy American Spaces, Dire Dawa American Corner. She is also a lecturer and licensed lawyer to practice before any court. Additionally, she is Young African Leadership, Regional Leadership Center (YALI RLC alumni), Mandela Washington Fellowship alumni, Pan African youth Leadership program of the U.S. government, and Meridian International Adult mentor and representative of Ethiopia as nominated by the embassy. She is also a Founder and Executive Director of Female Law Students and Legal Professional Network that works towards UNSDG goal #5.

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Future of architecture lies in it being ecologically sensitive wherein it incorporates water, waste, energy, biodiversity, food, and resources to build with

— **CHITRA VISHWANATH** —

Architect, Founder: Chitra Vishwanath Architects,
Managing Director: Biome Environmental Solutions



WOMEN EXPERTS

ENGINEERING, ARCHITECTURE AND CONSTRUCTION



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Fasika Solomon Legesse

ARCHITECT/DESIGNER

Fasika graduated from Ethiopian Institute of Architecture Building Construction and City Development (EiABC) in Architecture. After working for different corporate and local organizations in the creative field,

She is now the creative director of her own leather brand company called AWRA Studio after a tedious search for a stylish yet durable bag for herself.

Filagot Tesfaye Woldeselassie

ENERGY/ENGINEER

Filagot is founder of on energy consult, a licensed Engineer and a power sector expert. Filagot has various work experiences in engineering, construction, manufacturing, and energy – gender.

She has been an independent consultant for various energy projects including Power Africa East Africa Energy Program, ADELE World Bank Program, Energy2Equal Renewable Energy (RE) of IFC, and improved cookstove and Special initiative jobs program of GIZ. She is an expert of off-grid energy, clean cooking, grid extension, solar, energy efficiency, lighting, demand power and PAYG. Moreover, Filagot has initiated the Ethiopian Women in Energy Association (EWiEn), was the first president of EWiEn for three years and she regularly advocates the role of women in the energy sector as change agents and beneficiaries. Filagot's story was featured on various publications including SE4all and BBC media action Ethiopia and she has been selected by prestigious programs including Women4Climate of C40 cities, Mandela Washington Fellowship, Open Africa Power, Women in African power, and Global Women Network for Energy Transition (GWNET).



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Genet Hailu Melkegna

URBAN PLANNER

Genet is a professional urban planner working as senior spatial plan expert more than 6 years in different urban development local plans in Addis Ababa



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Helina Teklu Hailemariam

ARCHITECT/ENVIRONMENTAL ACTIVIST/GRAPHIC DESIGNER

Hilina has a Bachelor of Science in Architecture from EiABC (Ethiopian Institute of Architecture, Building Construction and City Development). She is also a graphic designer, an environmental activist, blogger for Sunsilk Ethiopia and works on women empowerment.

She is an Alumni of YALIRLCEA cohort 30 Civic Leadership track, Tony Elumelu Foundation fellow 2019, Connect4Climate (C4C), Climate Reality Leader and worked as the Networking and Events Chair for YALIRLCEA Ethiopian chapter (2019 – 2021). She was selected to be part of WE4A (Women Entrepreneurs for Africa) program in 2022. She has currently opened her own company called Seed Balls Ethiopia (SBE) where she fights climate change and the backward system of Agriculture in Ethiopia. Recently she has been awarded as the Earth Champion for climate change from East Africa by ICPAC

Hewan Goitom Berhane

ARCHITECT/HERITAGE CONSERVATIST

An architect focused on conservation of cultural heritage. Co-founded Heritage Conservation Associates offering consultancy for heritage and tourism development, protection policy advocacy, promotion, adaptive re-use and authentic conservation directly contributing to sustainable development.



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Kalkidan Tadesse Hunde

ARCHITECT/INTERIOR DESIGNER

Kalkidan was born in a family where she was encouraged to follow her artistic tendencies.

Her eye and talent for design took her from being a little girl who stood on chairs insisting on using cut-up old sheets as curtains all the way to university where she graduated with a Bachelors in Architecture and Urban Planning. Following her affinity for detailed art, her experience in the interior design business struck a chord with her passion for Ethiopian Culture She noticed that either cultural authenticity or design discipline were expected to be compromised upon. Her frustration grew with clothing fabrics being misused in interior design. That's how her Interior design company Balemuya Interiors and its brand child Meleya were born.



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Kulani Melaku Umeta

SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

Kulani started out as a data encoder and has since been working on front end development for the past six months.

She has a strong knowledge of coding languages such as HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Python as well as a strong understanding of the software development lifecycle and software engineering principles. She is highly organized and detail-oriented with excellent problem- solving skills.

Rakeb Kifle Alemu

CHEMICAL ENGINEER/BUSINESS DEVELOPER

A chemical engineer who specialized in bioenergy engineering and environmental engineering.

She has experience in teaching marketing and business development. She is especially interested in green energy technology.



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Yordanos Ashenafi Mekonnen

CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER/FEMINIST ADVOCATE

Yordanos is a graduate in construction management, she has more than five years' experience, she is currently employed at an interior works company.

She is well known for her active feminist advocacy on social media. She is an ardent supporter of equal opportunity for women and boldly express her stand using different social media outlets.



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[I Fight]
so that future generations will have the resources and assets they need to survive on a planet that's being destroyed every day

— **MIRIAM MIRANDA** —

A leader of the Black Fraternal Organization of Honduras (OFRANEH), which defends indigenous land rights and natural resources.



WOMEN EXPERTS

ENVIRONMENT CONSERVATION



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Aynalem Getachew Gashaw

ENVIRONMENT/SOCIAL WORK

Aynalem is a motivated individual with more than 19 years of experience in areas of Social and Environmental Impact Assessment (ESIA/ESMP), Land Acquisition and Resettlement Planning, Stakeholder Engagement, Corporate Social Responsibility, external relationship management, and community investment program development and implementation. Experienced in conducting assessment and implementation of UN Voluntary Principles on Security and Human Rights and thorough understanding and experience implementing IFC performance standards.

Her primary area of specialization is community and stakeholders relation, external relation, environmental and social impacts assessments and management, land acquisition and resettlement planning and implementation, E&S Due-diligence, small and medium-level business capacity building, media and communication, and social management of projects towards establishing social license involving applied experience derived through long-term engagement on community participation projects in the Oil and Gas, mining, and Geothermal energy projects. She has Master of Philosophy Degree in Culture, Environment, and Sustainability from the University of Oslo, Master of Arts Degree in Social Anthropology from Addis Ababa University, Diploma in Journalism and communication from Gimilikolen School of Journalism, Bachelor of Arts Degree in History from Addis Ababa University and certificate in Management of Community Benefits and Partnerships from the University of The Witwatersrand Johannesburg.

Banchiamlak Getnet Admasu

AQUATIC ECOLOGIST/RESEARCHER

Banchiamlak is a staff of Bahir Dar University, and teach courses such as, fish ecology, fish biology, water quality management and introduction to wetland.

She is actively engaged in the research and community service activity of the university. She is a member of Ethiopian Fisheries & Aquatic Sciences Association (EFASA), Member of Charitable Organization for Integrated Tana Basin of Bahir Dar, Ethiopia and Ethiopian Society of Animal Production (ESAP) and Ethiopian Society of Animal Production (ESAP).



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Bruktawit Abdu Mahamued

ORNITHOLOGIST/CONSERVATION BIOLOGIST

Bruktawit is an ornithologist and conservation biologist currently based at the Kotebe University of Education in Addis Ababa where she works as an assistant professor.

She has done several works at the field and internships in Ethiopia and other countries which helped to develop her practical bird survey skills such as conducting bird population surveys, bird ringing and raptor counts. She did her PhD in the UK on one of the Critically Endangered endemic birds in Ethiopia, the Liben Lark in order to help its survival. She has also been an EDGE Fellow with the Zoological Society of London working on another Critically Endangered bird, the White-winged Flufftail in Ethiopia. Bruktawit is also a 2022 fellow of Women for the Environment Africa.



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Hiwote Teshome Gebretsadek

ENERGY CONSULTANT

Hiwot is well versed in energy related issues including options and protection of the natural resources. Has experience in energy consultancy, promoting biomass and cooking energy. In her more than 25 years' experience she has developed a leadership quality.

Hiwote has MSc. degree in Renewable Energy from University of Oldenburg, Germany, and BSc. Degree in chemistry from Addis Ababa University. She has also got Diploma on professional Management by following a correspondence course given by Open University of UK in collaboration with A.A Commercial College. She was an International Energy Consultant. Based in Mozambique to support an organization in promoting biomass energy in general and addressing cooking energy aspects. She has specific expertise in the sustainable utilization of natural resources for improved food security through devising strategy for clean energy access (renewable energy resources) and implementation of projects, market development by also assessing the enabling environment of the sector, biomass energy conservation and cooking efficiency improvement and has also undertaken numerous energy studies including baseline surveys, stoves kitchen performance and impact tests plus project monitoring and general impact assessments.

Kenatu Angassa Wakuma (PhD)

ENVIRONMENTAL ENGINEER/LECTURER



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Kenatu is an Associate Professor at Addis Ababa Science and Technology University.

Kenatu received her Bachelor of Science in Applied Chemistry from Addis Ababa University in 2006, her Master of Science in Environmental Engineering from Addis Ababa Institute of Technology in 2011, and her Doctor of Philosophy in Water and Wastewater Treatment from the Ethiopian Institute of Water Resource at Addis Ababa University in 2018. Kenatu worked as a lecturer at the department of environmental engineering in the College of Biological and Chemical Engineering at the Addis Ababa Science and Technology University from September 2011 to November 2018 and from December 2018 to January 2023, as an assistant professor. Kenatu has more than 12 years of work experience in teaching, conducting research, and serving the community in the areas of water and wastewater, air pollution control, solid waste management, energy recovery from wastes, and thought for undergraduate and postgraduate courses for the discipline of environmental engineering. She has also supervised more than nine MSc Theses, and she is currently supervising five MSc students and one PhD student. In the field of environmental engineering, Kenatu has published more than 12 publications in peer-reviewed journals. Her area of interest is wastewater treatment research, water purification, air and water pollution control, solid waste management, and waste-to-energy conversion.



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Lulit Tilahun Wolde (PhD)

BIOTECHNOLOGIST/RESEARCHER

Lulit is an instructor and researcher in biotechnology at Addis Ababa University with a BSc in applied biology and MSc in biotechnology from Addis Ababa University.

She did her MSc in Biotechnology and a PhD in Industrial Biotechnology. Lulit did her MSc research at rift valley lakes such as Shalla, Abijata and Debrezeit lakes soda basic lake to see nitrogen cycle studying the bacteria living and reproducing in unfavorable conditions. She has found out that the bacteria keep the ecosystem friendly. This can be used in green industry to change harmful chemicals. She has done her PhD research in Danakil Depression, Dallol, Afar. She was the first one to prove life existed there. Lulit and her team found bacteria and archaea to clone and use bacteria to the fullest.



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Mekdes Nega Zegeye

SENIOR PLANT QUARANTINE INSPECTOR

Mekdes is a senior plant quarantine inspector at the Ministry of Agriculture.

She has MSc in Biology (insect science) from Addis Ababa University and BSc in plant science from Haramaya University. She has firsthand experience in crop production and protection as she has worked among farmers in North Shewa.

Yodit Balcha Hailemariam

CLIMATE CHANGE ADAPTATION SPECIALIST

Yodit is a founding member of the Women in Water Diplomacy Network and serves on the Network Leadership Council. Professionally she works as a Climate Adaptation research officer at the Alliance of Diversity International and CIAT-Africa Hub in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia.

Until early 2022, Yodit served as the Senior Climate Change Adaptation Advisor at the Ministry of Water, Irrigation, and Energy in Ethiopia, where she is responsible for mainstreaming climate change adaptation and resilience plans into the Ministries sectoral strategic and development projects. Her work focuses on the nexus approach of Climate, Land (Agriculture), Energy, and Water Systems. Yodit holds a Master's degree in Sustainable Development from Uppsala University, a Master's course in Agricultural Economics from Haramaya University, and Bachelor's Degree in Natural Resource Economics and Management from Mekelle University.



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No country can never truly flourish if it stifles the potential of its women and deprives itself of the contributions of half its citizens

— **MICHELLE OBAMA** —

An American attorney and author who served as the first lady of the United States from 2009 to 2017 as the wife of President Barack Obama

WOMEN EXPERTS

GENDER





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Abinet Tasew Sitotaw

GENDER ADVISOR

Abinet is a Senior Technical Advisor for Gender and Livelihoods at CARE USA.

She has over 13 years of experience in the fields of Gender, Agriculture, Nutrition, Education, and Child Protection. Previously, she served at Addis Ababa University in different capacities including as a Director for the Gender Office and a Lecturer at the Department of Philosophy followed by her role as a Senior Project Advisor at FHI 360. Abinet also worked as a Consultant for UNICEF, and Women's Strategic Development Center. She started her career as a journalist and her engagement with CARE started in 2016 with her role as a Gender and Nutrition Advisor at CARE Ethiopia. Currently, Abinet provides gender expertise to strategic food, nutrition and water security programs including research projects, and develops gender transformative tools and strategies for promoting gender equality in the agriculture sector. Abinet is a volunteer for International Institute of Education and Network of Ethiopian Women Association. She is also a board member for the Young Women Christian Association in Ethiopia. Abinet is a 2017 Mandela Washington Fellow and holds Masters' Degree in Gender Studies and a bachelor's degree in Philosophy from Addis Ababa University, Ethiopia.

Almaz Woldetensaye Edetto

GENDER/DEVELOPMENT



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Almaz has MA Degree in Gender Studies and BA Degree in Political Science and International Relations from Addis Ababa University.

She has worked for governmental and non-governmental organizations and UN agencies as an employee and consultant. Her research works focused on land policy, social policy, education, particularly girls' education, Harmful Traditional Practices, and other gender and development related issues. She has conducted trainings on issues of gender and different development issues, gender in leadership and decision making, gender assertiveness, gender mainstreaming in programs and projects and gender transformation. She has facilitated trainings, workshops, seminars, panel discussions and organized and led teams in different



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Ankets Petros Godana

GENDER/HUMAN RIGHTS

Ankets is passionate about working on human rights, gender equality and justice.

She has worked in the NGO sector in Ethiopia for more than 13 years on the professions of gender officer, program officer, gender specialist and now she is managing the Oxfam Ethiopia's Gender Program since 2020.



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Ayantu Ebba Chewaka

GENDER SPECIALIST

Ayantu has BA degree in History and MA degree in Gender Studies from Addis Ababa University. Currently, she is working as a National Gender Specialist at the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) Country office as a Gender focal point at both the national level and headquarter and handling women focus projects.

She has served as a program officer at UN Women Ethiopia on Rural Women Economic Empowerment (JP RWEE). She has started her journey of work as a journalist at RF. She has worked as an assistant producer -Anker person/news presenter and produced different programs.

Bethlehem Negash Woldeyohannes

GENDER/MEDIA/COMMUNICATION



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Bethlehem is a media and communications expert specializing on gender & media, representation of women in media and feminism in Ethiopia. Bethlehem has published research and assessments around gender representation in media in Ethiopia, made presentations at various national, regional conferences and workshops.

Bethlehem has an extensive experience in the field of communication, advocacy, public relations, and media. An active member of the Ethiopian Media Women Association (EMWA), Bethlehem holds an MA in Politics and the Mass Media from the University of Liverpool and BA in Foreign Languages and Literature from Addis Ababa University. Bethlehem is currently working at UN Women Ethiopia Country Office. A former journalist and gender equality advocate, she uses various platforms to write about gender equality and Women Empowerment. Among these platforms are Africanfeminism.com, a pan-African feminists' digital platform and collaborative writing project between African writers which aims to amplify African feminist voices. She also ran a weekly column on gender issues and politics in the Ethiopian news and information platform, Addis Maleda for over a year. Bethlehem is currently serving as a member of Advisory Council for Action Aid Ethiopia and is a member of The African Women's Development and Communications Network (FEMNET).



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Feteh Asrat Woldemichael

GENDER/WOMEN RIGHTS ADVOCATE

Feteh has MA in project management; B. A. in Gender and development and LLB degree.

She is a women right's activist and advocate for gender equality. She is experienced in facilitation of gender sensitization trainings, evidence-based advocacy, and gender transformative programing. She is well versed in project management concepts; human right based approach to programming gender analysis and management for planning and policy enrichment.



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Hawi Serbessa Hirpessa

GENDER EQUALITY/ SOCIAL INCLUSION

Hawi studied Economics, Public Relation and Strategic Communication. She is well experienced in gender, development and management.

Hawi has more than 14 years of solid experience in the development sector, in areas of women empowerment, gender equality, child protection, and social/downward accountability. She has accumulated years of experience working as projects lead for women empowerment and child protection, team leader in different projects and GESI lead at consortium levels. Her experience working at grassroots level added a live component on her experience as gender equality and social inclusion practitioner.

Hibiete Tesfaye Aberra

GENDER/WOMEN EMPOWERMENT/JOURNALISM

Hibiete is a gender expert with over 15 years of work experience with focus on Gender Equality, Women and youth Empowerment and Inclusion in development programs and institutional development.

She has also worked in journalism and teaching sectors at her earlier career development. Hibiete is a trained training facilitator. She produces training modules, coaches training facilitation skills to partners and delivers training. She has MA in Social Psychology, and bachelor's degree in foreign Languages and Literature. She is a graduate of the Executive Community Leadership Diploma Program provided by the collaboration of the Jönköping University (Sweden) and Addis Ababa University and sponsored by SIDA. She recently earned her diploma from Swedish Institute Management Program on Sustainable Management. She has work experience in Kenya, Tanzania and Japan in journalism, community development programs and the education sector.



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Hilina Berhanu Degefa

GENDER POLICY/FEMINIST ADVOCATE

Hilina is a gender policy and feminist advocacy expert. She has spent over a decade advocating for the recognition and fulfillment of women's rights through national and regional law and advocacy mechanisms.

She has served as a gender expert in human rights investigations, taught and conducted gender research at Higher educational institutions, led advocacy efforts under civil society organizations, and provided technical support for policy and law reform in Ethiopia. Hilina holds an LL.M in Law and Gender from SOAS, University of London, and LL. B in Law from Addis Ababa University. She is currently working as a gender and inclusion specialist at the United Nations Office in Vienna (UNOV).



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Messeret Legesse Burussa

GENDER CONSULTANT/CHEMIST

Messeret has MA degree in Gender Studies from Addis Ababa University. She was enrolled at Abo Akadamia University in Finland as an exchange student and attended advanced course on 'Feminist Perspective of Science Studies'.

Having first degree in the field of science, Meseret has served as quality control Chemist and microbiologist for different organizations in her earlier days of work life. After getting her second degree in Gender Studies, she joined the Women's Affairs department at Geological Survey of Ethiopia, under the Ministry of Mines. She also has a track record, working in various sectors including the women's affairs such as, human right, national election, house of representative, the road and transport, as well as the industrial sector. She has been actively involved in the preparation of national gender related manuals, national gender mainstreaming, leveling and data base framework and Training module. She has been working as gender advisor and consultant for various organizations, these services include; preparation of training manuals and provision of training, conducting assessments, gender auditing, GBV/VAW risk identification, anti-GBV/SH policy and Grievance handling guideline preparation, coaching and mentorships manual preparation, gender mainstreaming manual/GBV mitigation manuals and many more for projects sponsored by UNICEF, PACARD Foundation, World Bank, UN Women, African Development Bank.

Mulumebet Melaku Workagegnehu

GENDER/AUDIT/SOCIAL AFFAIRS



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Mulumebet has BA degree in Political Science and International Relations and MA in Gender Studies from Addis Ababa University.

She has worked for thirty five years in government organizations in different capacities mostly in managerial positions including :-Head of Women's Affairs Departments in Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Development,]; Director, Gender, and Social Affairs Directorate in Ethiopian Civil Aviation Authority; Head, Administration and Finance Departments in Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD); and Office of the Federal Auditor General (OFAG); Head, Organization and Management Division, (OFAG); Head personnel administration and General Service in Ministry of Agriculture MoA; Head, Division and Manpower Record and



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Mulumebet Zenebe Mekuria

GENDER/LECTURER/RESEARCHER

Mulumebet is associate professor at Center for Gender Studies, College of Development Studies, Addis Ababa University. She was director of the Institute of Gender Studies of Addis Ababa University from March 2008 to February 2010.

She has a wide experience in research and fieldwork in various parts of Ethiopia. Her research works have mainly been in the areas of gender and education, literature, women's networks, sexuality and reproductive health. Her research findings have been published in international journals and books. She has also participated at various national and international conferences and presented papers. Mulumebet has been involved in gender training and gender advisory work. She has served as board and advisory committee member of various local and international organizations.

Selamawit Tezera Chaka

GENDER/WOMEN RIGHTS

Selamawit is a Pan-African feminist, consultant, and writer who grounds her work in intersectional feminist politics as the foundation for disrupting unequal power structures. For several years now,

she has engaged in this work at a national, regional, and international level at organizations such as Earuyan Solutions, UN Women, Black Feminist Futures, FRIDA| the Young Feminist Fund, Internews, and others. Trained in economics and public health, her areas of interest and expertise have grown around feminist economics policies, programming and capacity building of grassroots movements to transit to civic society organizations, and feminist internet and digital security. She currently founded a digital platform, She Secures, that advocates for the digital rights and internet freedom of women.



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Selamawit Firdissa Duresa

GENDER/NUTRITION/AGRICULTURE/JOURNALIST

Selamawit has MA degree in Gender Studies. She has got her BA degree in Foreign Languages and Literature (major English and Minor Geography) from Addis Ababa University in 2001. She took short courses to strengthen her career, among others making agriculture work for nutrition and food systems approaches from Wageningen University and research (WUR). Currently she is working as a gender specialist at Alliance Bioversity International and International Center for Tropical Agriculture (CIAT).

Since she has her MA in 2013, she has served as full time and part time gender professional at different organizations and at different levels. She has worked as gender project manager, gender advisor, gender and nutrition expert, senior technical expert-gender, youth and nutrition for Ethiopian Horticulture Producer Exporter Association (EHPEA), CARE Ethiopia, Bilateral Ethiopian Netherlands Efforts for Food, Income and Trade (BENEFIT), Agricultural Transformation Institute (ATI) respectively. Her career in gender gave her opportunities to travel to different parts of Ethiopia and understand rural women and girls' issues, efforts that have been made by government and non-government partners to empower women. She was also involved in part-time consultancy tasks for PSI-Ethiopia, Ethiopian Media Women Association and ABidan Consultancy, and understand about issues of commercial sex workers, latrine utilization of Afar areas, evaluation of self-help groups approached implemented with support of Danish Church Aid (DCA).

Selome Desta Belay

MEDIA/GENDER



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Selome worked for radio Ethiopia as a reporter, senior editor, and coordinator. In addition, she was co-founder and Coordinator of FM Addis 97.1, the first FM radio station in Ethiopia. She worked for Deutsch Welle in Germany Cologne and Bonn, as a Senior Editor.

Later, she joined Population Media Center (PMC) as Senior Editor and Radio Programs Coordinator. Leaving PMC, she was hired by Global Press Institute (GPI) as Country Editor. Her significant roles were coordinating and giving trainings; translating and preparing training materials on girls' issues related to media campaigns; and lastly writing and editing scripts posted on GPI's Newswire. She also worked for Internews as Media Monitoring Expert attached to the Ethiopian Media Authority (EMA). Her role was monitoring broadcasting media before and during the 2021 election period. She also provided guidance to EMA's media monitors by sharing ideas, and editing their reports. Selome, who received B.A in Foreign Language and Literature from Addis Ababa University has been engaged in gender and media advocacy. She conducted, co-conducted, and coordinated some research and training activities in relation to the media. Currently, she is persisting with this engagement. Her unique passion is participating in volunteer activities. As a member, she worked for the survival of the Ethiopian Media Women Association and the Ethiopian Women Lawyers Association. She is participating as a member of the Women's Health Association of Ethiopia, Ethiopian Women Human Rights Defenders Network, and currently, as President of Soroptimist International Addis Ababa Club.



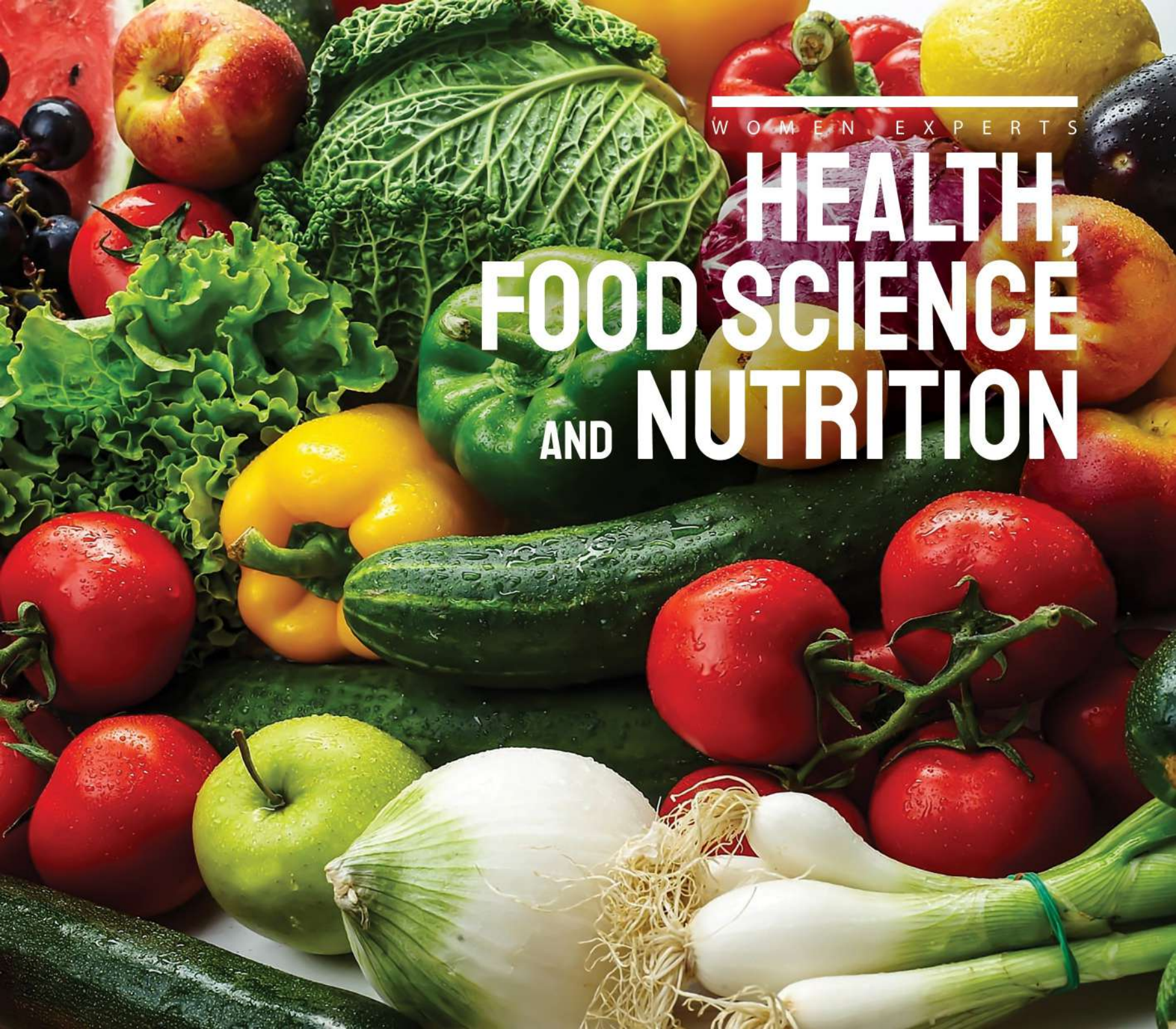
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Siyane Aniley Amentie

GENDER/RESEARCHER/TRAINER

Siyane has been working in the field of education, sexual reproductive health rights, and gender research and training for more than a decade.

She is finalizing her Ph.D studies by researching the policy and practice of sexuality education in the context of Ethiopia and Uganda at Addis Ababa University. She has so far co-authored three publications on internationally reputable journals and writing ongoing studies. Siyane has been involved in running training for ministerial-level experts, media professionals and civil service officers. She is currently working for the Center for International Reproductive Health and Training (CIRHT) on Sexual reproductive health rights research and advocacy.



WOMEN EXPERTS

HEALTH, FOOD SCIENCE AND NUTRITION



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Professor Aster Tsegaye Abebe

IMMUNO-HEMATOLOGY

Aster is a Professor of Immuo-Hematology, at the Department of Medical Laboratory Sciences, College of Health Sciences, of Addis Ababa University. She obtained her BSc (Biology, minor Chemistry) and MSc (Zoology) from Addis Ababa University; PhD in HIV Immunology from University of Amsterdam, The Netherlands.

Aster has more than 30 years of experience providing routine clinical laboratory diagnostic services in Hematology, Serology and Immunology laboratories; Research (in the field of Immunology/Hematology, HIV/AIDS and other infectious & non-infectious diseases); Teaching medical laboratory professionals; and Leading/managing Laboratories, Department, School and the largest Teaching Hospital. Her leadership experience include: Head of Hematology Laboratory, Manager of The Ethio-Netherlands AIDS Research Project Laboratory, Research & Training Coordinator of the National HIV Laboratory, Director School of Medical Laboratory Technology, CEO of Tikur Anbessa Specialized Hospital, and Dean Sante Medical College during sabbatical leave. She has authored or co-authored about 110 Scientific Publications and has advised/co-advised over 150 graduate students (including 3 completed 8 ongoing PhD students). She is currently engaged in bringing more women in science and research through mentoring and providing trainings. She is the recipient of awards for outstanding contribution to the field of Medical Laboratory Science Profession; outstanding contribution in HIV/AIDS training from JHPIEGO; best scientific research from Ethiopian Medical Association (twice), and from College of Health Sciences of AAU, Exemplary Female Researcher from Ministry of Higher Education (MoSHE); Outstanding Female Researcher of CHS, AAU and recognition from Patient Associations (Hemophilia, Chronic Myelocytic Leukemia, Podoconiosis). She is a member Research Committee of African Forum for Research and Education in Health (AFREhealth); V/Board chair Cancer Care Ethiopia; founder and President of the Society of Ethiopian Women in Science and Technology; Fellow & Executive Board of the Ethiopian Academy of Sciences.

Dr. Alpha Seifu Ali

SURGEON/LECTURER

Alpha is an assistant professor of orthopedic and trauma surgery, as well as a consultant surgeon. She has received her medical degree from Addis Ababa University in 2017.

Her research interests include trauma care, surgical systems strengthening, preventing trauma-related death and disability, road and occupational safety, and osteoporosis, specifically fragility fractures. She has publications in reputable journals and is interested in implementing innovative measures to improve clinical service. She is an aspiring global surgery leader seeking experience in advocacy and evidence-informed policy development.



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Dr. Betelehem Belay Kassa

PULMONARY AND CRITICAL CARE PHYSICIAN

Betelehem is a Pediatric Pulmonary and Critical Care Physician as well as an Assistant professor of Pediatrics and Child Health at Addis Ababa University, College of Health Sciences, Tikur Anbessa Hospital.

She was the head of the Department of Pediatrics and Child health at Haramaya University and worked as a General Practitioner. She also served on several University statutory bodies during her stay at Haramaya University. She is currently serving as the Deputy Head of the Department of Pediatrics and child Health at Addis Ababa University. In addition, she is a board member of the Ethiopian Pediatric Society. She has also been recognized for her community work with the Good Will Medical Mission and the Ethiopian Diabetes Association. She is also a member of the Ethiopian Thoracic society (ETS) and the American Thoracic Society (ATS).



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Bezuayehu Tegegn Gebrewold

PHARMACIST/PUBLIC HEALTH/PROCUREMENT

Bezuayehu has nine years of experience, in public health commodity supply chain and rational use as Pharmaceuticals Quantification.
She is also experienced in organizing and delivery of different training, mentoring, TWG, workshops, and review meetings with and for key supply chain stakeholders with the ultimate goal to ensure commodity security. She is also involved in the pharmaceutical's association and international association of public health logistics to share experience and contribute on her behalf to the development of the supply chain environment.



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Dr. Bilen Kora Gelaye

SURGEON/OTOLOGY

Bilen is an Otorhinolaryngology, Head and Neck specialist surgeon with a subspecialty in the field of Otology.
She received her M.D from The University of Gonder, college of Medical and Health sciences and her specialty certificate in Otorhinolaryngology, Head and Neck surgery, from Addis Ababa University, college of Medical and health sciences. She has also received a sub- specialty certificate in the field of otology from University of Illinois-section of otology/ Neurotology, Ethiopian fellowship program. Blen is a member of Ethiopian Medical Association, secretary of Otorhinolaryngology, Head and Neck surgery Processional's Society Ethiopia and member and current treasurer of Hearing for Ethiopia Association.

Dagmawit Tewahido Haimanot (PhD)

PUBLIC HEATH/PHILOSOPHY/LECTURER



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Dagmawit (MPH, PhD) is a public health expert and Assistant professor of health promotion and qualitative research methods at Addis Continental Institute of Public Health. Served as a clinician, Health officer, in a rural Government hospital in, Gelemso, West Hararghe, prior to fully shifting to public health research and academia.

She has far-reaching training in public health and research. She pursued her PhD in public health, with a focus area of adolescent girls Sexual and Reproductive Health (SRH) and the role of social norms in sexual behavior. She teaches and advises graduate students. She has also been involved in leading different research projects as a coordinator as well as a technical expert. Her particular expertise includes qualitative and mixed research methods, health behavior and health communication. Dagmawit has experience in leadership of short-and long-term research and training projects including, but not limited to, SRH, Adolescent health, social norms, Health Ethics and Scientific writing, Monitoring and Evaluation of Nutrition, Health behavior and Non- communicable diseases. She also has extensive operational field research experience in various urban and rural settings in Ethiopia. She has numerous experiences collaborating with national and international organization for research and training projects. Dagmawit leads large-scale adolescent multi-national adolescent health research projects and published about 11 scientific articles as principal and co-author. She has also participated in and collaborated on different curriculum review workshops for health programs. She is a member of prominent professional associations such as EPHA, EHEPPA, EGLF and Global social norms LC. She is also affiliated with the Ethiopian Ministry of Health in national collaborations, including being a member of the adolescent and youth health thematic group of the RMNCAH/N Research Advisory Council (RAC) and the Seqota Declaration Urban implementation research team member.



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Dr. Fasika Shimeles Teferra

PHYSICIAN/SOCIAL ENTERPRISE

Fasika is a medical doctor by training and is passionate about elevating health literacy and patient empowerment through innovative digital solutions. She runs a social enterprise in partnership with her husband.



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Dr. Fikerte Woldeselassie Woldeyohannes

PUBLIC HEALTH/LECTURER

Fikerte is an instructor at Dagmawi Menelik Health Science College and has served the hospital for seven years. She has an MSc in Public Health from Haramaya University and PhD from the University of South Africa.

She has BA in political science and international relations an MA in Gender Studies from Addis Ababa University. She participates in research and advises students in the fields of laboratory, pharmacy, nursing, nursing theory and practice. She was awarded CRC (caring respected compassionate health professionals) Award in 2016 from the Health Care Bureau.

Genet Getachew Kebede

PUBLIC HEALTH/CLINICAL NURSING



A public health specialist with a background of clinical nursing with vast experience working over 15 years in the areas of reproductive health, prevention and control of infectious disease mainly HIV/AIDS and Tuberculosis and sexually transmitted infections and hepatitis. Provided clinical care at heath facilities, managed HIV/AIDS and related programs at national levels at Ministry of Health Ethiopia.

She has a key role in the national and regional planning, monitoring and evaluation of the programs including capacity building, development of policy, strategies and guidelines and training manuals; involved in research work, proposal development and supervision.

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Dr. Hana Abebe Gebreselassie

PEDIATRIC SURGEON/LECTURER



Hana is a medical doctor with eight years of experience.

Currently, she is working as Assistant Professor of Pediatrics Surgery in the Surgical Department of St. Paul's Hospital Millennium Medical Collage where she is responsible for performing surgical procedures on neonates and children, teaching and mentoring surgical residents and conducting health related research. She is also a Fellow of College of Surgeons of East, Central and South Africa. She is working to start a project that aims to raise awareness about pediatric surgical disorders. Her project also aims to incorporate quality improvement programs on neonatal surgical care. Dr. Hana was a Mandela Washington Fellow in 2022 and has attended a training on Civic Leadership in Rutgers University.

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Hiwot Solomon Taffese (PhD)

PUBLIC HEALTH

Hiwot Solomon is director of Disease Prevention & Control, at the Ministry of Health. She is a PhD Candidate for public health in the University of South Africa. She has got her MSc in Public Health from Maastricht University and has completed her BSc in Applied Biology from Addis Ababa University.

She has training in the following areas, TOT for TB, Leprosy, TB/HIV Management, International TB/ HIV Course for Managers at National & Sub national Level, Improve TB Laboratory Diagnosis in Countries with High Burdens of HIV/TB Co-Infections, Malaria Surveillance Planning & Management of Tropical Disease Control Programs, Malaria Entomology & Vector Control, Leadership, Management & Governance. She has experience as national Malaria Program Team Leader/ Program Manager: at the and Tuberculosis & Leprosy Officer at the Ministry of Health. She has publications in Malaria Journal (2021) (https://malariajournal.biomedcentral.com/articles/10.1186/s12936-021-03655-9) Malaria epidemiology and interventions in Ethiopia from 2001 to 2016. Infectious Diseases of Poverty (2018).

Dr. Kalkidan Alachew Admasu

PHYSICIAN /ENDOCRINOLOGY

Kalkidan is a sub-specialist in endocrinology and metabolism with over 10 years' experience working in both private and government health institutions.

She is an experienced leader and has served in various managerial roles including director of the emergency department and director of inpatient services. She has established a gestational DM as well as collaborative diabetic foot ulcer clinic within ALERT hospital. She is founder and previous secretary of the Ethiopian Medical Women's Association.



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Dr. Kidist Lemma Gizachew

OBSTETRICIAN/GYNECOLOGIST

Kidist is an obstetrician and gynecologist working in Ethiopia.

She has extensive experience in provision of sexual and reproductive health care service for vulnerable and marginalized segment of the population. She is also active in development of guidelines, training manuals, doing multicenter research and provision of mentoring and supervision.



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Dr. Mahlet Kifle Habtemariam

PUBLIC HEALTH/HEALTH POLICY AND STRATEGY

Mahlet is a Senior Regional Engagement Advisor at the Africa Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (Africa CDC). With over a decade of practice in public health,

Mahlet has vast experience in formulating health policies and strategies and directing health programs at national and regional levels. In her previous role at Africa CDC, she worked as a Principal Program Officer, leading the executive office and the agency's key priority initiatives. Before that, she held progressively responsible positions at the Ministry of Health of Ethiopia, including the Chief of Staff role in the Office of the Minister. Mahlet is an active member of various technical advisory committees and governing boards. She holds a Doctor of Medicine from Addis Ababa University and a Master of Public Health from University College Dublin. She is a Takemi Fellow of the Harvard T. H. Chan School of Public Health and an African Public Health Leaders Fellow at Chatham House.



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Mekides Wolde Debela

NUTRITIONIST

Specialized in Human Nutrition with public health educational background. She has 15 years of experience in govt and non-government organization.

Dr. Melhick Asrat Alemayehu

CLINICAL MENTOR

A dedicated general practitioner, with 6 years' experience fulfilling various roles as a clinician, lecturer, and clinical mentor, and is certified in multiple CME accredited courses.

Has considerable experience with health writing work concerning Mental Health and HIV care prevention and treatment. Passionately volunteers for several organizations devoted to causes such as climate change, women's empowerment and mental health and well-being as a speaker, writer, researcher and editor.



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Dr. Nardos Worku Ketema

PEDIATRIC ORTHOPEDIC SURGEON

Nardos is an Orthopedic Surgeon with a sub-specialty in the field of Pediatric Orthopedics. She received her M.D and specialty certificate from Addis Ababa University, College of Medical and Health sciences.

She has also received a sub specialty certificate in the field of Pediatric Orthopedics from Cure Hospital. She has both Specialty (Orthopedics) and Sub-specialty (Pediatric Orthopedics) certificate from College of Surgeons of East, Central and South Africa (COSECSA). She has received a Master's degree in MPH from Jimma University with an outstanding score. She has won a Women Scholarship Program developed by American College of surgeons (ACS) and COSECSA in 2017.



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Dr. Rania Ibrahim Mohammed

HEALTH CARE/PUBLIC HEALTH

Rania is currently the founder and Executive Director of Innova Healthcare Consultancy, a pioneer in consultancy services in the Ethiopian Healthcare Sector.

She has over ten years of experience in the healthcare sector of Ethiopia from a medical and public health perspective ranging from working as Senior Technical Advisor for the Federal Ministry of Health to introducing breakthrough structural and functional integrations to the Existing healthcare practices, a notable mention being the establishment of the Innovative Strategies and Operations office at St. Paul's Hospital Millennium Medical College (SPHMMC). In her endeavors, she is more drawn to public health and strategic planning-related projects due to her passion for dynamic, demanding, and high-impact work. In 2010, she co-founded Telemed-Hellodoctor Ethiopia, a technology startup that increased healthcare access by providing medical telephone consultations to vulnerable populations. Rania built upon these experiences to develop balanced strategic decision-making skills and resolve systemic issues. She is also interested in providing a human-centered approach to healthcare solutions, as evident in her current role as a product development lead in ChePharma, a tech startup company that aims to bring seminal changes in the digitalization of the Ethiopian Pharmaceutical Supply Chain. She received her medical degree in 2010 from Addis Ababa University Medical Faculty. In 2018, she completed an entrepreneurship master's program at the University of Notre Dame.

Dr. Ruth Leekassa Bekana

DERMATOLOGIST

Ruth has more than 3 decades of experience as a physician and practicing Dermatology. Graduated from Addis Ababa University as a medical doctor in 1982 G.C. and specialized in dermatology at the University of Wales in 1995 G.C.

She has worked in various capacities of leadership as a medical director of ALERT hospital and founded a private practice called RANK dermatology clinic in 2005 G.C. which has grown into a diverse portfolio of businesses. She currently practices dermatology at RANK Specialized dermatology clinic and run the business as a general manager.



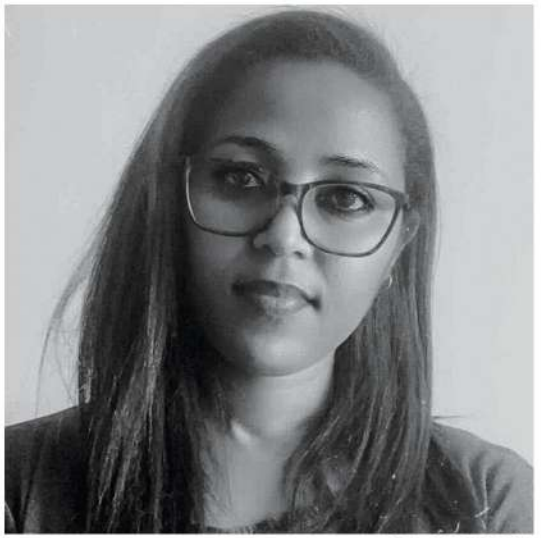
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Senait Bitew Alemu

PUBLIC HEALTH/NURSE

Senait is a passionate public health professional and oversees the design and delivery of programs and strategic plans for Lifebox in East and Southern Africa.

A nurse by training, Senait has extensive experience working in the hospital and healthcare sectors. Prior to joining Lifebox, Senait worked as a Public Health Consultant, and has previously worked at Jhpiego as a Prevention of mother-to-child transmission (PMTCT) Advisor as well holding various roles with organizations including Médecins Sans Frontières, AIDS Resource Center, and Intrahealth International. Senait earned her nursing degree from Gondar University, and her Mph from Addis Continental Institute of Public Health (ACIPH).



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Dr. Sofia Kebede Berhanekirstos

EMERGENCY PHYSICIAN

Sophia is an Emergency Physician working in Tikur Anbessa Hospital under the Addis Ababa University and the Vice President of EMewa (Ethiopian Medical Women`s association).



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Dr. Winta Mehari Tekeste

DIRECTOR SHALOM HEALTH CARE

Winta is the CEO/Director of shalom healthcare solutions a medical equipment manufacturing and medicine importing company that is registered and well established in USA, Canada and Ethiopia.

She is working hard to improve Ethiopia healthcare system by manufacturing quality PPEs with the aim of exporting to all neighboring countries.

Dr. Zelalem Debebe Mengistu

DIETITIAN/NUTRITIONIST



Zelalem is a doctor of Medicine and has BSc Dietetics and Nutrition with over 20 years' experience working as dietitian in Hospitals and Community, in the UK and Ethiopia and has obtained her MSc in Dietetics in 2015.

She studied at Jimma University and graduated as Doctor of Medicine, then Studied at King's College London, and graduated with BSc Nutrition and Dietetics. She is now working as a dietitian at Balance Health and Nutrition Consulting Plc. providing Medical Nutritional Therapy, care and advice for individuals and groups. Zelalem is an assistant professor at Addis Ababa University, center for Food Science and Nutrition. She is also the member of Mathewos Wondu Cancer Society, and Ethiopian Diabetes Association.

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Dr. Yemisirach Bizuneh Akililu

NEUROSURGEON



Yemisirach has graduated form College of Health Sciences, school of Medicine at Addis Ababa University. She has worked in Limu Genet district hospital to give public service and worked there for a year.

She joined the neurosurgery residency teaching program and graduated as a neurosurgeon in 2018 G.C. She has been involved in different research activities and has interest in outreach programs organized by different institutions.

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Professor Workabeba Abebe Taye

PEDIATRICS/CHILD HEALTH

Prof. Workeabeba is an Associate Professor at the Department of Pediatrics and Child Health, College Health Sciences, Addis Ababa University (AAU). She is also a Consultant Pediatrician and the first Pediatric Infectious Diseases sub-specialist at Tikur Anbessa Specialized Hospital (TASH).

Her research interests focus on childhood infectious diseases mainly pediatric HIV, hospital epidemiology, antimicrobial resistance, and antimicrobial stewardship. Currently, she is PI of the research project on surveillance of healthcare-associated infections and feasible laboratory-strengthening interventions for a sustainable clinical bacteriology sector to support antimicrobial stewardship at TASH. She has published over 75 peer-reviewed research articles in reputable journals. She has supervised research projects for several residents, besides clinical teaching, providing mentorship, and supervision of diverse groups of students. She has received the best scientific paper award from the Ethiopian Medical Association (EMA) in 2004 and a certificate of recognition from the Ministry of Science and Technology (MoST) in 2018. She is fellow of the Young Academy of Sciences at the Ethiopian Academy of Sciences. She is member of the Editorial Boards of Ethiopian Journal Pediatric and Child Health and Ethiopian Medical Journal and Executive Committee (EC) member of the Society of Ethiopian Women in Science and Technology (SWiST). She is also member of technical and advisory groups for pediatric ART at the Federal Ministry of Health; Chair of Adverse effect following immunization (AEFI) at Ethiopian Food and Drug Authority (EFDA), member of the National Immunization Technical Advisory Group (NITAG) and EC member for the National Certificate Committee (NCC) for Polio free status of Ethiopia. She is a founding member of the Women Health Research Working Group (WHRWG) at AAU. Currently, she is chair of Department of Pediatrics and Child health, College of Health Sciences, Addis Ababa.

Dr. Genet Kifle Alemu

EMERGENCY/CRITICAL CARE/DISASTER RESPONSE

Genet is a medical doctor; she did her specialty in emergency and critical care.

She is looking forward in doing her sub-specialty in Disaster medicine. She is currently working at Alert Comprehensive Hospital as Emergency and ICU director. She has been working with Ministry of Health on crisis management and disaster response.



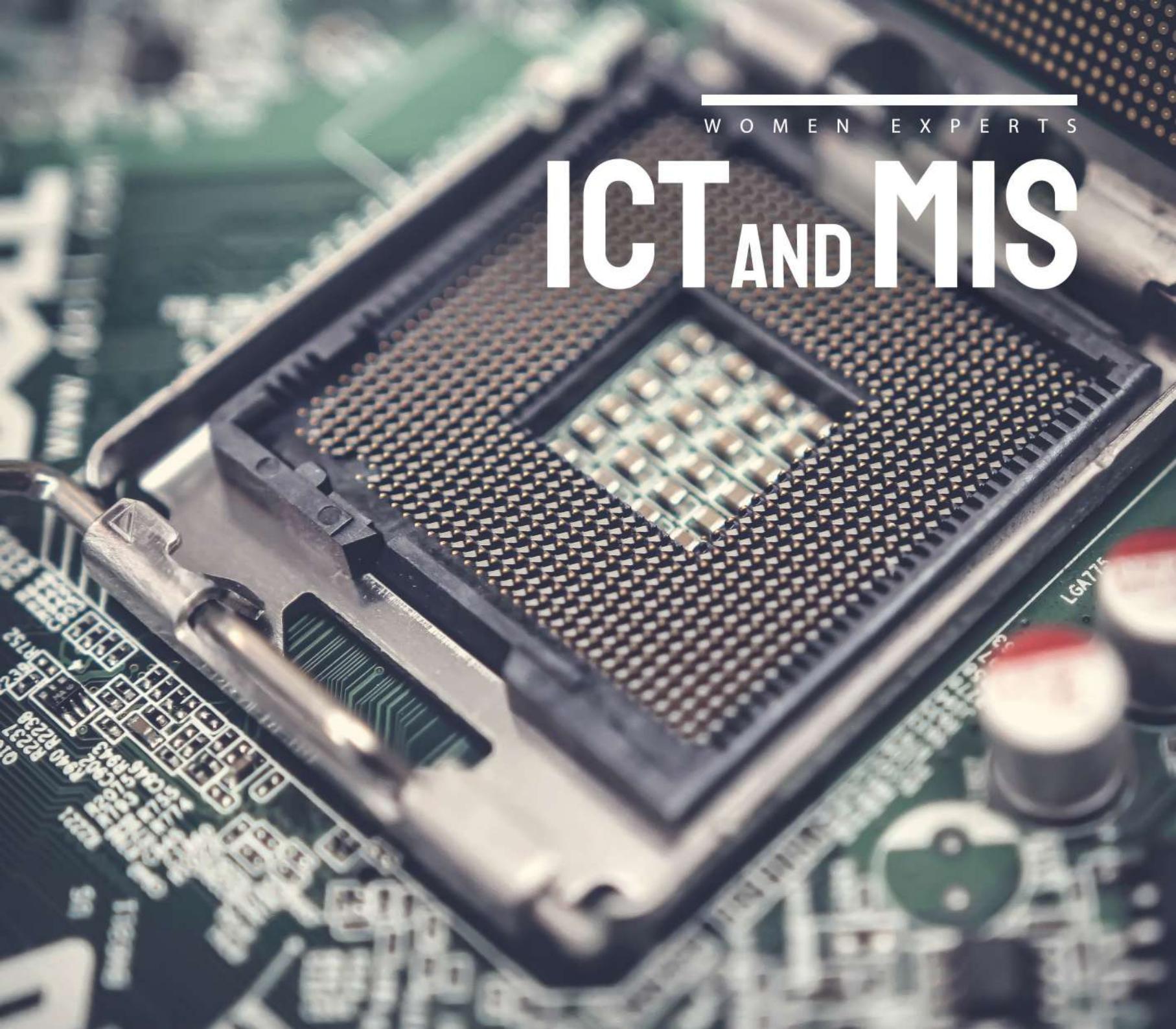
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A new, a vast, and a powerful language is developed for the future use of analysis, in which to wield its truths so that these may become of more speedy and accurate practical application for the purposes of mankind than the means hitherto in our possession have rendered possible

— **ADA LOVELACE** —

English mathematician and writer, chiefly known for her work on Charles Babbage's proposed mechanical general-purpose computer, the Analytical Engine


WOMEN EXPERTS
ICT AND MIS

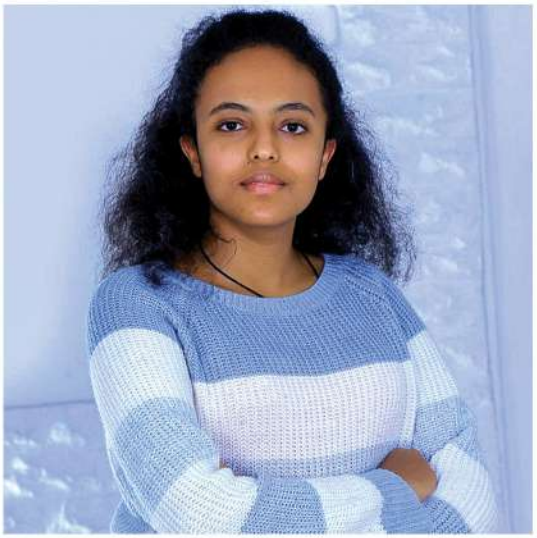


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HAWI ATOMSA DABA

WEBSITE ADMINISTRATOR/DATABASE ADMINISTRATOR

Hawi has graduated with Computers Sciences BSc from Addis Ababa University, working indifferent organizations for almost 14 years as a Lecturer, website Administrator, Infrastructure Team Leader, Database Administrator and currently she is working as ICT director in a Government Organization.



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Lidya Sefefe Doya

SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

Lidya is product management professional working in digital financial services at Safaricom Telecommunications Ethiopia.

She has been working as a Software developer and project manager for the past five years. She has MA in Project Management and has completed different technical skill certificate courses.

Sebah Tewodros Tekletsion

COMPUTER ENGINEER/WEB DEVELOPER



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Sebah is a computer engineering graduate from the University of Gondar in 2019. She is also a Nativity Girls School alumna and has been working as a web developer for various Ethiopian companies ever since leaving school.

Additionally, she is the head of communication and advocacy Team for the Yellow Movement, an organization dedicated to empowering young people to make positive changes in their communities. Sebah has always been passionate about technology and its potential to create positive change in society. After graduating from university, she decided to pursue a career in web development and quickly gained experience working with various companies. In addition to her work as a web developer, she also actively involved in the Yellow Movement, leading its efforts, helping to spread awareness about its mission and goals. Through her work with the Yellow Movement, Sabah hopes to inspire other young girls to take action and make a difference in their communities regarding gender equality and women's rights.



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Selamawit Belete Kebede

TELECOMMUNICATION ENGINEER/CYBER SECURITY

Selamawit has MSc in Telecommunication Engineering from Addis Ababa University; MSc in Software Engineering from HiLCoE School of Computer Science and Technology, BSc in Computer Engineering from Microlink Information Technology College.

She is trained and certified as Information Security Manager, Detecting & defending against cyber threat, cyber security Compliance Framework & System Administration; Cyber security roles; Process and Operating system security and big data analytics in telecommunication.



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Sisay Tadele Jote

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Sisay is a software engineer who is graduated from Haramaya University. Currently she is doing her MA in sociology.

She has worked as a layout and graphic designer and head of Asian and African affairs and ICT directorate director at the mayor's office of Addis Ababa



WOMEN EXPERTS

LAW AND HUMAN RIGHTS



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Asnaketch Getnet Ayele

LAW/DEVELOPMENT/LECTURER

Asnaketch has got her first degree from Jimma University in law, she pursued her Masters in law development from Warwick University.

She is now pursuing her PhD in Law and development from a university in Netherlands. She has served as lecturer in Gondar, Addis Ababa and Bahir Dar Universities. Her PHD study focuses on article 35(4) and aims to safeguard the rights of women in traditional courts.



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Dunia Mekonnen Tegegn

HUMAN RIGHTS/INTERNATIONAL SECURITY

Dunia is an Ethiopian human rights lawyer who has been working with the American Bar Association's Center for Human Rights where she coordinated the Center's work on Ethiopia through close collaboration with Ethiopia's Democracy and Human Rights CSOs to ensure human rights are prioritized and protected within the criminal justice system.

In her home country Ethiopia, Dunia worked with the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights Eastern Africa Regional Office (OHCHR EARO), the United Nations Agency for Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment and the United Nations Children's Fund. Dunia was also admitted as a lecturer of law at Haramaya University Law School and has taught law in several universities in her country. In 2016, Dunia was named as the first Ethiopian/African woman to receive a National Security LLM with distinction from Georgetown University's Women's Law and Public Policy Program.

Eden Fissiha Hailu

HUMAN RIGHTS/WOMEN RIGHTS ADVOCATE/RESEARCHER

Eden is an Assistant Professor of Law at Bahir Dar University. She has a master's degree in law in Development from University of Warwick.

She taught Law for twelve years. Eden is a researcher, human rights defender as well as women's rights advocate. She has publications on Women's rights. Currently, she is serving as the Executive Director of the Association for Human Rights in Ethiopia (AHRE).



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Eyerusalem Belay Tulu

LEGAL/CIVIC ENGAGEMENT/RESEARCHER

Eyerusalem is a legal professional, researcher and civic space professional based in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia with over three years of experience developing and implementing civic engagement, legal and humanitarian programs, developing monitoring and evaluation systems, overall grant management and donor and stakeholder engagement.



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Helen Tilahun Teshome

LAWYER/SOCIAL RESEARCHER

Helen works as an Executive director in the organization called New Life Teen Challenge Development and Relief Program.



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Lensa Biyena Geleta

HUMAN RIGHTS/GENDER EQUALITY

Lensa is an Executive Directress of Ethiopian Women Lawyers Association (EWLA). Lensa pursued her postgraduate in International gender studies at University of Iceland (HON) and Law (LLB) at Mekelle University and her MSC in project planning and management.

She has 10 years of professional experience, leading, coordinating, researching, advocating and implementing human rights, gender equality and democracy programs with special focus on women rights in Ethiopia. She participated in various law and policy reforms and also took and provide several trainings on Human and democratic rights, Transitional Justice, peace and security, advocacy and leadership. Lensa has served and is serving as a board of director, founding member and research and advocacy advisor of several CSO organizations. She is a young professional passionate in advocating matters that concerns Human rights and Democracy specializing in Gender.

Ledet Teka Befekadu

HUMANITARIAN /PEACE/SECURITY SPECIALIST



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Ledet's area of expertise includes humanitarian, peace and security currently working on women, peace and security Agenda.

She has over 15 years' experience in various United Nation (UN) entities supporting different organs of the African Union. Prior to UN, she had a chance to work with regional and local organizations including south African think tank Institute for Security Studies (ISS) and the media sector. She is an alumni of IPSS Executive Program for Global Studies in Peace and Securities in Africa & has another Masters in Media Peace and Conflict Studies from University of Peace (UPEACE) , Costa Rica. She is member of several initiatives working on conflict prevention and peace making including the African Union Network of Women in Conflict Prevention and Mediation (FemWISE).

Lidet Gebrehiwot Worku

LEGAL/HUMAN RIGHTS



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Lidet is a graduate of Law from Mekelle university school of Law. She pursued her LLM in International human rights law from Addis Ababa university, College of Law and Governance.

She has practiced as a legal assistant for a year. She has for almost 3 years worked in a civil society organization under women and youth empowerment program-focused projects. She is currently working as a Women's Rights Officer, at the Ethiopian Human Rights Commission.



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Mahlet Abreham Tibebu

HUMAN RIGHTS/GENDER

Mahlet is a Program Directress at the Ethiopian Human Rights Defenders Center. She oversees programs and deals extensively with organizational development and program management. Mahlet specialized in International Human Rights Law.

She received her master's in International Human Rights Law from the University of Sussex in Brighton, UK Before joining EHRDC she worked with Catholic Relief Service (CRS) where she was responsible for coordinating the design and implementation, technical assistance on projects and advisory services on an emergency program specifically on issues of gender and protection. She has also extensive research experience and publications in which she investigates issues of women's rights such as the protection of internally displaced women, women's political participation, and Conflict-related sexual violence.

Makeda Getahun Wolde

LEGAL /COMMUNICATION



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Makeda is a project management, communication, and legal professional with 10 years of working experience on legal affairs, training, strategy development, communication and program coordination.

Her career started as a legal expert in private organizations social security agency where she has developed her expertise as a legal professional, trainer and communicator on private pension law and Ethiopian labor law. Correspondingly, she has also worked on training coordination, research, partnerships with different government and private lead organizations. She has also worked as a Project Coordinator for World Bank funded program- Urban institutional and infrastructure development assisting Federal Ethics and Anti-Corruption Commission executing its responsibility in the program. Currently, she is working as Partnership Coordinator at Concern Worldwide Ethiopia. She holds Master's Degree in Public relations and strategic communications, Bachelor of Arts in political science and international relations and also LLB degree in law.



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Meseret Ali Kassegne

LAW/GENDER ADVOCACY/PEACE/SECURITY/MEDIA

Meseret has a law background skilled in gender, advocacy & program management, particularly in women's political participation in political decision-making, peace, and security, and women's economic empowerment agenda.

She has over 10 years of service in different fields, and various institutions; local and international CSO, NGOs as well as in media. Her professional carrier began as a sponsorship correspondent at the SOS Children Village Ethiopia. She has also served as the program coordinator for the Ethiopian Orthodox Church Development & Inter-Church Aid Commission mainly focusing on coordinating field projects, at the Norwegian Church Aid, Oslo, Norway she has served in the capacity of Gender and Peace officer. She has taken and given various pieces of training on Gender, Feminism principles, Peace & Conflict, Community mobilization, and transformative leadership. She has joined Sheger FM 102 as a program co-host and writer, further going into the media landscape of the country as a trainer. Currently, she is serving as a program manager in the Network of Ethiopian Women's Associations (NEWA). She is also currently serving on different committees for UNSC Resolution 1325 NAP development process & chairwoman of the CSO Forum on Women, Peace, and Security in Ethiopia also serving Ministry of Women & Social Affairs Technical Advisory Group member for the national Gender-Based Violence Policy, Global Advisory Board, Women's Economic Empowerment Publish What You Fund and, Plan International Ethiopia Women Voice Leader Project Technical Advisor.

Saba Gebriel Gebremariam

LAWYER/JOURNALIST

Saba is working in Asham Tv as a lawyer and program producer.

She wants to bring more to the society and aims to participate in gender equality.
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Selam Gebretsion Beyene

SOCIAL JUSTICE/GENDER EQUALITY/WOMEN EMPOWERMENT

Selam has had the privilege of researching, assessing, and influencing laws and policies that impact the lives of women's and vulnerable groups in Africa.

She also has rich experience in giving capacity building trainings and organizing events on issues of gender equality, women empowerment, harmful traditional practices, early marriage, human trafficking, protection, and fulfilment of human rights particularly for women, vulnerable groups and ethnic minorities. She has worked with government institutions, multilateral organizations, consulting firms, and NGOs. She has MA in Gender Studies from Addis Ababa University, LLM in Criminal Justice from the University of Western Cape and LLB from Jimma University.



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Tayechalem Girma Moges (PhD)

HUMAN RIGHTS/WOMEN RIGHTS/GENDER

Tayechalem has PhD in Law from the University of Melbourne, Australia, LLM in Human Rights from and MA in Gender Studies from Addis Ababa University. Her major training is on human rights, women's and girls' rights and gender studies.

She has served as assistant Professor, (part-time) at the center for Human Rights, in School of Law and Governance, Addis Ababa University. She was also a project manager for East and Southern Africa in strengthening CSOs for ending child marriages. She also worked in Plan International African Union Liaison Office, and was an independent Consultant on Human Rights and Gender Equality in Sub-Saharan Africa. She served as Project Coordinator in enhancing the voices of Civil Society to end Child Marriage (Coordinating 4 countries - Tanzania, Zambia, Malawi & Zimbabwe- in advocacy project). She also served as a lecturer at School of Law and Governance Studies, Addis Ababa University & Institute of Federalism and Legal Studies and Civil Service University. She has published research paper on Counting Absence in Political Equality, a Gender Analysis of the New Electoral Law of Ethiopia, co-author (Publication September 2020); Feminist Research Methodology Training Module, UN Women - Centre for Human Rights, Addis Ababa University (2019); The Regulation of Violence: Child Wives, Custom and the Formal Law in Ethiopia, (2019 publication pending - Frankfurt University/Frobenius Institute). Among her conference Presentations the following can be cited. Preliminary findings of the research Developing a Transformative Human Rights Approach towards the Practice of (girl) Early Marriage in Ethiopia on Human Rights in an Age of Ambiguity Conference hosted by Fordham, University at its Lincoln Center campus, NYC in June 2016. (Published online); Child-Friendly Methods for Engaging children as Research Participants, Research with and For Children.

Yemserach Legesse Hailu

HUMAN RIGHT/SOCIAL WORK/MEDIA/LECTURER



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Yemserach is Law School graduate from Addis Ababa University. She did her masters in two professions: Human Rights and Social Work.

Her professional experience includes working as reporter in Addis Fortune newspaper, Gender Office Coordinator in College of Natural Sciences of Addis Ababa University, Assistant Project Officer in FAWE, Advocate Assistant in a law firm and Program Director in Women's Strategic Development Center. Yemserach is an advocate for peace, girl's education, women and youth leadership and empowerment, human rights, environment, and many social causes. She is also part time consultant, trainer, and researcher in different governmental and non-governmental organizations. Yemserach is currently working as a lecturer in School of Law and Federalism,
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Zemdena Abebe Areru

HUMAN RIGHTS/GENDER SPECIALIST

Zemdena Abebe leads Strategic Initiative for Women in the Horn of Africa (SIHA) Network Ethiopia. As a Pan-Africanist womanist, she is committed to disrupting interlocking oppressive systems through her expertise in intersectional feminism, pacifist activism work, research, writing, multimedia -storytelling, community organizing, movement building, collective care praxis and transformational leadership.

Her social justice advocacy work started in high school when she Chaired Addis Ababa Girls' Forum-which facilitated discussions and organizing amongst girls laying the foundation for reforming legislative intervention against sexual abuse in Ethiopia. As the first women president of Addis Ababa University Students' Union: she reaffirmed the need for and organized various youth-led student movements despite the hostile university context. One of the 22 young African women selected as part of the writing for social change workshop organized by AWDF and FEMRITE in Kampala, Uganda. An alumnus of the prestigious Mandela Washington Fellowship. Amongst her multilayered affiliations, she sits on the advisory council of ActionAid Ethiopia. Zemdena is a graduate of Political Science & International Relations. Asserting the notion that African women and girls have the right to a life free of patriarchal injustices, sexual violence and conflict :she has attended and organized peaceful protests ,lead the formation of women peace press clubs, WHRDs coalition, migrant returnees association feminist peace lab , convened virtual and in-person safe spaces for marginalized women from diverse backgrounds, built the capacity of grassroots women on WSPs advocacy tactics, social media campaigning, as well as written Memos and common position paper on various topics including National Dialogue. Her writings of existence and resistance can be found on Pambazuka, Africa is a Country, HBF, African Feminism et al.

WOMEN EXPERTS

LEADERSHIP AND GOOD GOVERNANCE





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Abebech Dechassa Gerbi

POLITICAL PARTY LEADER

Abebech is the head of the women department in Boro Democratic Party. She is also secretary of the Ethiopian Political Party Joint Council's women wing.

She has BA degree in Water Resources and Irrigation from Gondar University. She is now working in Benishangul region, Metekel zone, Debate Woreda as a team leader on clean water infrastructure construction and maintenance.

Bethlehem Mehari Belachew

GOOD GOVERNANCE/CONFLICT MITIGATION



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Bethlehem is the Director and Editor-in-Chief at Horn Review. As co-founder, she oversees research and training programs, as well as the editorial process at Horn Review. Bethlehem holds a B.A. in Comparative Politics from Furman University and an M.A. in International Economics and Conflict Management from the Johns Hopkins University, School of Advanced International Studies (SAIS).

Her research interests include intractable and identity-based conflicts, negotiation process and design, as well as climate change and the onset of conflict. Prior to her work at Horn Review, Bethlehem worked with the Ethiopian Ministry of Federal Affairs in the design of government approaches to preventing and managing conflict. She also worked with FARM Africa's Building Resilience and Adaptation Against Climate Extremes and Disasters (BRACED) project in assessing benefits of microfinance institutions in aiding low-income households recover from natural disasters. Most recently, she worked with the Center for Development and Strategy (CDS) as an External Relations Manager, and served as an Admissions Ambassador with the Johns Hopkins University SAIS from 2018 to 2020.



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Desta Tilahun Endeshaw

POLITICIAN

Desta has politically engaged to solve the problematic political history of Ethiopia as a member of EPRP for the last three years.

She worked as a clinical nurse for six years. She was a pharmacist and a lecturer at a university and she is a pharmacology candidate at Addis Ababa University.

Ethiopia
Tilahun Abebe

LEADERSHIP/DEVELOPMENT/TRAINER



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Ethiopia is a compassionate and visionary leader who has 20 plus years of experience on youth, women empowerment and girls' education and leadership development programs.

She has been highly involved on various programs that aim the enhancement of young people in general and women and girls in particular. Inspired by the dedication of the then young leaders who decided to take part in stopping the spread of HIV/AIDS back in the late 1990s, her career journey begun as being a branch manager for a youth-led organization which strives not only to 'Save the Generation' from alarming HIV/AIDS and reproductive health problems but also envisions to build a productive active young citizen. Eventually, influenced by her own firsthand exposure and profound experience, Ethiopia has now become a prominent advocate for youth and women & girls participation in all developmental agendas of the country. Ethiopia has more than fifteen years of proven experience in delivering training and facilitation on different thematic areas such as reproductive health and HIV/AIDS, leadership, mentorship, life skills, presentation skills and gender at national and international level. She participated in the development of the HIV Stigma Action Tool Kit and she is an African Regional Trainer of this Tool Kit. Besides, the United Nations Development Program (UNDP) has recognized her as Transformational Leadership Facilitator. Currently, she is the Head of IIE Sub-Saharan Africa and Ethiopia office. Among her main responsibilities, overseeing the strategic direction and the overall management of the Institution, supervising the scholarship program, higher education services, leadership development initiatives and training.



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Fozia Birru Ali

OMBUSMAN DIRECTERSS

Fozia is a directress of the Ombusman office in Afar in the Department of Women, Children, and People with Disabilities Directorate.

Fozia has BA degree in Theatrical Arts from Addis Ababa University and Management Degree from Rift Valley University. She is on the final stage of completing her Master's degree in Sociology. She has played a notable role in the establishment of the Museum of the region.



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GELILA HAILU LERA

POLITICIAN

Gelila lives in Wolaita and she is the leader of wolaita biherawi niknake.

Gelila uses social media to promote the unique culture of Wolayita, and shows allegiance with those whose voice needs to be heard. She actively works to advance the development concerns of the Wolayita people and is an advocate of heritage conservation.

Hamelmal Kibre Mulat

LEADERSHIP

Hamelmal has Master's degree In Leadership from Dila University. In 2017, she served as a Women's League Chairperson in Guragie Zone, Sodo Woreda.

She served in Women, child & youth affairs in Guragie zone, Sodo Woreda from 2008 to 2014. She became president of Guragie Zone Women's Federation from 2015 to 2016 and she is Guragie Zone council member from 2014 until now. She is the director of Women, child & youth directorate in Federal cooperative Agency from 2016 to 2022.



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Kidest Girma Mekonnen

POLITICIAN

Kidest is a politician and executive member the Ethiopian Citizens for Social Justice (EZEMA) party and head of Ethiopian political parties joint council wing.



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Tsige Haile Woldegiorgis

LEADERSHIP/WOMEN EMPOWERMENT SPECIALIST

Tsigie is the founder and director of the Organization for Women in Self Employment (WISE), a local non-governmental organization operating in Ethiopia. Tsgie had her BA from Addis Ababa University and MBA from the Netherlands.

She worked for over 20 years at the Addis Ababa University, both in the administrative and academic wings, before joining the development sector. After leaving the University, she joined ActionAid Ethiopia and served for four years in the capacity of Human Resource Development Manager. While working at ActionAid, she decided to set up WISE and work with poor women and girls. The Organization Tsigie leads has served over100000 low-income women in support of their efforts to become empowered and improve the quality of their lives. WISE is currently a leading organization in women's economic empowerment in the country. Tsigie serves in many governing boards and committees of different organizations and has received a number of recognitions for her contribution to poverty reduction and women's empowerment.

WOMEN EXPERTS

MANAGEMENT, ADMINISTRATION AND HUMAN RESOURCE





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Aberash Tsehay woldegeorgis

MANAGEMENT/DEVELOPMENT

Aberash has received her Master's Degree in Management and Development with a specialization in social inclusion, Gender, and Rural livelihoods. She has more than 30 years of experience at NGOs and GOs.

She has worked as a Program Coordinator, Department Head for Women in Development, Project Officer, and Home Economics Expert. She was involved in introducing small-scale improved postharvest handling, storage, and agro-processing technologies. She has played a role in job creation for rural women and youth by engaging them in threshing/shelling services and small scale agro-processing enterprises. She has facilitated training on postharvest handling, storage management, agro-processing, and human nutrition for farmers. She is currently working in Sasakawa Africa Association as Technical Coordinator for Nutrition-Sensitive Agriculture.



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Kalkidan Girma

MANAGEMENT/TRAINER

Kalkidan Girma is the co-founder of KEMMCOM; a Management Consulting firm that provides advisory, consulting and training services in two major practice areas: Corporate Affairs and Corporate Development.

Kalkidan leads the Corporate Development practice with emphasis on developing business strategy, organizational health assessment, corporate strengthening, change management, facilitating soft skill trainings and implementing diversity and inclusion (D&I). Having worked in both the government and private sectors in the U.S. and Ethiopia for over 20 years, Kalkidan brings a wealth of experience and expertise in institutionalizing companies along with a proven track record of exceeding the expectations of stakeholders. Prior to focusing full-time on KEMMCOM, Kalkidan served as Management Specialist at the U.S. Embassy located in Addis Ababa handling different mission critical projects.



WOMEN EXPERTS

MEDIA, COMMUNICATION AND PUBLIC RELATIONS



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Abaynesh Birru Shibeshi

MEDIA DEVELOPMENT/COMMUNICATION/JOURNALISM

Abaynesh currently is a Social Behavior Change Communication/SBCC/ expert with a journalism background. She has worked as a radio journalist for 19 years at different levels in Radio Ethiopia and then joined the NGO sector and worked as a Social Behavior Change Communication/ SBCC/ expert and advisor in the area of health and social development for over 15 years.

She has built her Gender related knowledge since her days in Radio Ethiopia and then during her experience as a SBCC expert. As a woman radio journalist who have faced many challenges, she had contributed and still contributing a lot in building the capacity of media women in the area of Gender and Media through the Ethiopia Media Women Association. Currently she is working as a Media and Communication consultant and Advisor in SBCC. Her area of work covers SBCC strategy development, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of SBC programs, development of training manuals, discussion guides, handbooks etc. and provision of training on media, Gender, Alternative Child Care and SBCC related programs. Abaynesh is a MA graduate in Social Psychology from Addis Ababa University.

Elizabeth Baslyos Lakew

EDITOR/COMMUNICATOR

Elizabeth is working at Ethiopian Institute of Agricultural Research (EIAR) as Scientific Papers Editor and Communication Director.



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Elsa Assefa Geteneh

JOURNALIST

Elsa has more than 15 years of experience in radio and television journalism.

As a program producer at Fana Broadcasting Corporation, she has gained popularity among the listeners by hosting the 90-minutes and 120-minutes live broadcasts, which were very popular and well-liked by the listeners and was the top show of Fana Broadcasting. She also worked as a newsreader at Addis TV. Currently, in addition to her own radio program SILEGNA, she is also the co-host of MESSE RESORT at Bisrat FM 101.1.



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Elshaday Gebeyehu Mekonnen

GENDER/COMMUNICATION

Elshaday is a communications expert with wide-ranging experience in the media and communications field ranging from documentary filmmaking to providing strategic communications direction and media relations. Through her various capacities in the field, she has developed an extensive knowledge of Ethiopia's mainstream and social media landscape.

She houses a lifetime commitment to social justice, gender equality and community development to which she has been contributing her share through storytelling and generating human interest communications for advocacy on gender equality, development and humanitarian contexts. Elshaday holds a Master of Science Degree in Media and Communications from the University of Liverpool and a Bachelor of Arts degree in Management from Addis Ababa University.

Emebet Demeke Belay

JOURNALIST/PRODUCER



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Emebet has MA in Journalism and Communications and BA in Television journalism from Addis Ababa University.

Her major expertise areas are lead and master trainer of electoral actors, fact checking for media professionals, screen writing for women professionals, online fact checking training for women editors and senior journalists, radio feature making, radio production, digital editing using adobe audition, program narrative, planning, recording and production. She worked as program coordinator, editor and show producer at LTV, news, health, women and youth program editor at Ethiopian Broadcasting Corporation /EBC/, and women and youth program Editor at FM 97.1.

Ethiopis Tadesse Deribe

GENDER/COMMUNICATION/PUBLIC SPEAKING



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Ethiopis is a Communications Specialist with vast experience in communications and advocacy work.

She is a Distinguished Toastmaster, public speaking coach and soft skills trainer. Ethiopis has a keen passion for youth empowerment and development, which derives from her desire to address Ethiopia's critical issue of youth unemployment. She has dedicated much of her time to supporting unemployed youth in developing skills by delivering soft skills and employability trainings, as well as mentoring.



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Hilina Mebratu Belay

GENDER/COMMUNICATION

Hilina has Bachelor's degree in Journalism and Communication and Master's in Gender Studies from Bahir Dar University. She has served as a journalist for over 15 years.

She has served as a reporter, editor of entertainment programs and Head of online monitoring department in Amhara Media Corporation. She has prepared notable programs on disability and gender and a strong program called Agenda which focuses on issues called hard in the media circle.



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Kibre Tesfaye Abebe

JOURNALIST/EVENT ORGANIZER

Kibre has MA in Journalism and Communication and BA in management from Addis Ababa University.

She has worked as a journalist at reporter newspaper and was senior producer of various programs at Fana Broadcasting Corporate. She has worked with the TV show Ethiopian Idol as a weekly host and facilitator. Kibre was also a producer of Etege show with Arts Tv. She is currently working at Bisrat FM 101.1 on different social and health issues.

Kidist Kifleyohannes Zawde

MEDIA/COMMUNICATION/FILM



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Kidist has MA in Amharic Literature and Folklore from Addis Ababa University and BA in Theology from Holy Trinity Theology College. Her major trainings are on film editing, the role of media communication in combating harmful traditional practices, self- regulation and formation of media council and media and children's Right.

She has participated in Haile Gerima's Teza feature film as promoter and coordinator. She has produced and hosted radio Programs such as Biruh Tesfa on Radio Ethiopia and Edil on radio FM. She was also a program producer and host in radio fana and also served as assistant film director in Yewenzoch Maebel by Salem Mekuria. She was also an actress and has shown her talent in the city council of Addis Ababa theater and cultural hall, Ras Theater, Addis Ababa University theatrical arts department and cultural center, in a film by Ethiopian Film Corporation called " B'hiwot zuria ", in a weekly radio play entitled "Mefcha " and a play entitled " Agul Tsebay". Kidist has contributed her share as a board member of Ethiopian Media Women Association. She has an honorary cup award and certificate for her share as one of the contributors for the Ethiopian film industry in its 50 years journey.



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Kiya Ali Abamecha

FACT CHECKER/BUSINESS JOURNALIST

Kiya works for Code for Africa (CfA). Prior to joining CfA, she was a reporter for the Ethiopian Business Review magazine. She has taken part in the European Journalism Centre project called Interruptrr Africa.

She has a Bachelor of Science Degree in Electrical and Computer Engineering from Addis Ababa Institute of Technology. Also, she has earned a Bachelor of Arts Degree in Economics from Unity University. Kiya won a gold medal and trophy from Unity University for academic excellence. She is a 2019 YALI RLC EA fellow. She is interested in economics, fact-checking, investigative journalism, technology, gender equality, development issues, SDGs, and Agenda 2063. She is also a fellow at ONE.



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Lediya Abebe Negussie

JOURNALIST

Lidya is an editor -in-chief and currently produces various radio and TV shows. She is well recognized by "Ethiopiawi Wenzoch," which is a show produced once a week on radio. It focuses on the GERD, bilateral cooperation, water policy, diplomatic issues and international laws.

She also produces the station's editorial article on political, economic and social issues to enlighten the general public and criticize voids in the structure of the government. "Lisane Mircha 2013" is another successful radio show which focuses on election issues. She was leading the debate among the 6th national election. "Kela" is her TV show in which prominent political figures appear and discuss current political affairs.

Melkamsew Solomon Tafesse

GENDER/MEDIA

Melkamsew is a journalist, a radio producer, a media trainer, mentor and a media entrepreneur. She began her career as a radio producer in 2004. She has produced programs and reports that up lift development of women and girls in the society.

She has also served as senior producer and trainer at BBC media action Ethiopia where she mentored other producers in radio stations across the different parts of the country. She has MA in Journalism and Communication and BA in Foreign Languages and Literature from Addis Ababa University. Her major trainings are on reporting resilience, media leadership, radio production, public service announcement production and social media management. Currently, she is working as a media advisor for a weekly women radio show named 'Yimechish' which discusses decisions women make every day and how it affects their lives.



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Metasebia Shewaye Yilma

MEDIA/COMMUNICATION/FACILITATOR

Metasebia has over 20 years of experience, in print to radio and television as reporter, producer and presenter as well as master of ceremonies to high level events.

She has worked with various local and international private, not-for-profit and governmental institutions. She also has hosted corporate and social events as master of ceremonies, lead high level meetings and moderated panels on various topics. She has a deep understanding of the Ethiopian media landscape with a wide network across Africa. Among her works in media are: - Producer & presenter of the first mobile app-based live interactive TV game show in Ethiopia, Meda Shi on Fana TV - Producer and host of the popular unique experiential travel show, Let's Go with Meti, on LTV - Co-founder and producer of the highest income generating syndicated infotainment show, Tadias Addis, on Sheger FM 102.1 - The only Ethiopian contestant in the continental reality show, Survivor Africa in Panama, on M-Net Channel on DSTV - Co-hosted the Ethiopian episode of a Pan-African travel show, Destinations Africa, on EbonyLife TV on DSTV - Co-hosted on the Pan-African magazine show, Studio 54, on M-Net Channel on DSTV. Metasebia has founded QUEENDOM.MEDIA, a Pan-African multimedia production house focusing on television programs, documentaries, personal and company profiles, and advertisements. Metasebia has served in the board of AWIB (Association of Women in Boldness) was its president in 2018. She closely works with youth groups such as AIESEC and Rotaract clubs. She also mentors young women in Meri Mentorship Program by Earuyan Solutions as well as young women's leadership program of the Ministry of Women, Youth and Children.

Rahwa Gebremeskel Gebrearegawi

BRANDING/ COMMUNICATION

Rahwa combines marketing, media and strategy to tell stories.

Working for Heineken and Euromonitor International among others, her professional experience spans in research, brand management, fashion, media and creative communication sectors. Based in Ethiopia, Rahwa currently works at Unbox Marketing; a result-oriented consumer research, brand strategy, brand design, website development and digital communications agency she co-founded. Rahwa holds a BA in business administration, master's in Marketing Management and is a 2019 Mandela Washington fellow.



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Rehobot Ayalew Mengiste

MEDIA/FACT CHECKER/TRAINER

Rehobot is a fact-checker and an independent media consultant. She is a founder of Niqu Ethiopia, a media consultancy, that focuses on countering disinformation and enhancing media literacy in Ethiopia.

She is working as a consultant and a trainer with different organizations. Previously she worked as a lead fact-checker at one of the local fact-checking initiative, HaqCheck/ Inform Africa. She worked as a show host, participates in research, and engages in other countering disinformation related activities.



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Ruth Bekele Woldearegay

MEDIA/TRAINER

Ruth holds a Master's Degree in Media, Campaigning and Social Change from the University of Westminster, London.

She has over eight years' experience in media productions and media training. She specializes in radio and podcast productions, and media capacity building trainings.

Selam Mussie Tadesse

GENDER/MEDIA

Selam is a media consultant specializing in the intersection of media with gender, conflict, and social change.

She has over 10 years of experience working as a country lead, capacity development lead, writer, strategist, campaigner, researcher, and trainer. Selam has also developed multiple guides, training manuals, and campaign strategies to create social awareness on gender and contribute to a more responsible media that is sensitive to gender and conflict reporting.



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Tekabech Assefa Sahile

MEDIA/JOURNALISM

Tekabech has MA in Journalism from Comenius University - Brtislava Czechoslovakia.

She has obtained certificate from Kotebe Teachers Training. Among her previous experience the notable ones are president of Ethiopian media women's Association, editor of Addis Zemen Amharic daily news-paper, Information center head of Ethiopian Press Agency, Information center assistant at Ethiopian Press Agency; Head of women's Affairs Department at Ministry of Information, editor: Women's page on Addis Zemen Amharic daily newspaper and editor of Yekatit Amharic monthly magazine.



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Tigist Kassa Miliko

MEDIA/COMMUNICATIONS

Tigist is an award-winning journalist, storyteller, radio personality, and experienced content developer who displays an ability to write balanced, informative, and interesting stories that allow all involved parties to have their say.

Tigist has specialized in strategic communications and experienced in designing and implementing Social and Behavior Change (SBCC/C4D), advocacy, campaign, social mobilization, knowledge management and currently works as a head of Influencing and Communications and technical advisor on Demand Creation and Gender.



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Tigist Mekonnen Abeje

MEDIA RESEARCHER

Tigist has BA and MA in Journalism and Communications, and has been teaching, researching and trainings on the area for the last 15 years.

She has been working as a chief editor and graphic designer of Bahir Dar University's monthly newspaper.

Tensay Tadele Jemberie

JOURNALIST/DIRECTOR/PRODUCER

Tinsay has taken several courses in film making (Including videography, photography, editing, script writing and directing), graphic Design and Information technology after earning her bachelor's degree in Journalism and Communication.

Currently, she is the general manager, executive producer and director in her own company, black gold. Her company, is a creative advertising, communication and production company that engages in Radio and TV productions, advertising, branding, graphic design, publications and creative visual arts.



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Tirist Yetbarek Seme

MEDIA/COMMUNICATIONS

Tirist Yetbarek is a journalism educator affiliated with Jigjiga University. She is also a regional peace and security expert of the Horn of Africa with a background of Peace and Security Studies.

Her area of interest is in communication, peace and reconciliation, and socio-linguistics description of communities.



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Tsehaye Teferedegn Woldeyesus

MEDIA/COMMUNICATION

Tsehay has MA in journalism and communication from Addis Ababa University.

She has served in the field of journalism as senior producer and editor of social and educational programs, women's forum program, health program, children program, Behiwot Zuriya- a family program, Ethiopian Enkagnat a tourism program and Sunday morning and various other programs for the last 40 years. She is now serving as communications specialist in Ethiopian Society of obstetric and gynecologists association. Tsehay received an award of life time achievement as the best journalist for her contribution on world radio day which was celebrated in Ethiopia for the first time in 2019.



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Yiftusera Tuji Wolkeba

MEDIA/NEWS ANCHOR/PRODUCER

Yiftusera is a manager of Yiftusera Advertising. She was a producer and presenter of 'Addis Gets' radio program on FM Addis 97.1 and producer at population media center.

She also was a program producer, news anchor and presenter at Ethiopian Worldwide Television. She is presently a news anchor at Addis Media Network. Yiftusera has BA in Journalism and Communication from Addis Ababa University.

WOMEN EXPERTS

SOCIAL WELFARE, CHILD PROTECTION, LABOR





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Aregash Geleta Nega

SOCIAL WORK/COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT

Aregash has MA in Social Work and Community Development and BA Degree in Accounting,

she has an experience of 15 years managing projects/programs finance, complex community developments, roll-out in strategy planning management, execution projects/programs and track progress against setting goals. transformational roles in their community.



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Bekelech Demesie Rorisa

WOMEN EMPOWERMENT/SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT

Bekelech is founder and Executive Director of Save Generation Development Association (SGDA).She created positive influence on the empowerment of women and girls through her fight for the rights of girls and women.

She started with a humble beginning of a government school teacher and taught there for six years and at the same time she got her Bachelor's. She found an organization called Save Generation Development Association (SGDA). The organization focuses on women and children and gender-based violence. She is serving the association for the last 14 years as executive directress.

Mulualem Tamire Shiferaw

EDUCATION CONSULTANT/SOCIAL WORKER

Mulualem is managing director of Women & Girls Support-Ethiopia; An NGO focused in alleviating the health & livelihood difficulties of girl students and the less fortunate women in Ethiopia.



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Semeret Demeke Woldetsadik

CHILD PROTECTION/COMMUNICATION

Semeret is a country director of Tabitha Reach Ethiopia. She has MA in Holistic Child Development from Evangelical Theological College and BA in from Economics, from Unity University.

She has training in project management, communication for development, community empowerment projects, managerial communication, performance management and change management. She has served as communications officer at Children's Hope chest, Ethiopia, sponsor and donor associate at Compassion International Ethiopia.



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Worknesh Begi Wakdiyo

COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT/EDUCATION

Worknesh has got her degree from Kotebe Teachers Training College to teach Home Economics and Biology. She has taught for 10 years in three high schools then changed her profession and started to work at Gudina Tumsa Foundation at positions of education program officer and gender officer.

She has earned Bachelor's degree in community development from Metro State University in the United States and came back to her country to found Tarkanfi Sustainable Development which was active for the last ten years in areas of education, women and girls rights, peach building, conflict resolution and humanitarian activities.



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Zertihun Tefera Sekecho

WOMEN EMPOWERMENT/DEVELOPMENT

Zerthun has BA and Masters' degree in development management and organizational leadership. She has started her journey 25 years ago based on her concern for gender equality in her society.

Hence she has founded Siiqqee Women's Development Association to empower destitute women in her community. The project presently is benefiting more than 60, 000 women in eight zones of Oromia region. The organization is governed by board of directors. The name Siiqqee is believed to symbolize the traditional empowerment initiatives used to be the advocates of women rights.

WOMEN EXPERTS

TOURISM AND CULTURE





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Blen Tilayneh Meles

ANTHROPOLOGIST/LECTURER

Blen has attended MedaWelabu University and earned a BA degree in history and heritage management. She was a graduate assistant at Mekelle University.

She has done her MA in social anthropology. She has returned to Mekelle University to carry out research on various gender-related topics and to teach undergraduate and MA courses in the anthropology department. She provides senior essay advice, co-advise MA research papers, and guide female students by discussing gender-based violence, life skills, and the sexual violence policy of Mekelle University. She has also served as the institute of paleo-environment and heritage conservation's gender focal person which has made it possible for her to comprehend the difficulties faced by female university students in their academic and educational involvement, which is often linked with their gender identity and cultural background. She is currently a third-year PhD student in the Department of anthropology at the University of Nairobi in Kenya. Her Ph.D. is associated with a project called Decent Work and GVC-based Industrialization in Ethiopia, in which she is undertaking labor ethnographic research at industrial parks on the role of gender and its implications for global value governance.

Kiya Gezahegne Wotere

SOCIAL ANTHROPOLOGY/GENDER/RESEARCHER



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Kiya is an experienced researcher and an assistant professor based at the Department of Social Anthropology, Addis Ababa University, Ethiopia.

She has been involved in ethnographic research for over ten years on a range of migration and refugee related areas including experiences of Ethiopian migrants to and from the Middle East, Sudan, Libya and Europe. She has also researched refugee protection, migration and refugee policy, migration management and livelihoods at the Ethiopia-Sudan border, interlinkages between migration and poverty in Ethiopia, as well as understanding migration and the labor market among others. She has also intensively researched religion, religious identity and religious relations. She has also worked on adolescents and child wellbeing for over six years, focusing on education, bodily integrity, health and nutrition, psychosocial wellbeing, economic empowerment, and voice and agency. Her research has also looked into slavery and marginalized communities, women empowerment, financial inclusion, health and nutrition of mothers and children, gender and policy, gender and media, youth aspiration and resilience, among others.



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Roman Tafesswork Gomeju

TOURISM/MARKETING/SOCIAL WORK

Roman has BA degree in Hotel Management from Hawassa University and M.A in Marketing Management from Addis Ababa University.

She has worked as a General Manager, Director and Managing Director for high level four- and five-stars hotels in Ethiopia. She is now the National Key Accounts Manager for Coca Cola Beverages Africa.

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